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Mumbai

"Bombay" redirects here. For other uses, see [Bombay \(disambiguation\)](#).

Mumbai (Marathi and Hindi: मुंबई *Mumbaī*), formerly known as **Bombay**, is one of the largest cities in [India](#) and the capital of the state [Maharashtra](#). A cosmopolitan metropolis, Mumbai was built on seven islands on the [Konkan](#) coastline which over time were joined to form the island city of Bombay. The island was in turn joined with the neighbouring island of Salsette to form "Greater Bombay". The city has an estimated metropolitan population of 20 million (2025), making it one of the world's most populous cities.

Often called the "[New York of India](#)", Mumbai is undoubtedly the country's commercial capital and one of the predominant port cities. Mumbai's nature as the most eclectic and cosmopolitan Indian city is symbolised in the presence of *Bollywood* within the city, the centre of the globally-influential Hindi film and TV industries. It is also home to India's largest slum population, as well as the iconic Gateway of India built on the waterfront of Mumbai Harbour during the British Raj.

The name Bombay comes from Bom Bahia ("the good bay" in Portuguese), a name given by explorer Francis Almeida. Mumbai is named after the goddess Mumbadevi of the Koli community.



Gateway of India



Districts

Mumbai is a city built in successive waves of migrations. The neighbourhoods acquired their character from the communities that settled there first. These neighbourhoods are too numerous to list and there is no commonly accepted way to group these neighbourhoods into larger districts. But roughly, from the south to the north, this is how the city developed.

East and West

A visitor to Mumbai's suburbs will quickly learn that almost all localities in Mumbai with railway stations have a "West" side and an "East" side. "West" means west of the railway line, and "East" means east of the

Old Mumbai

Old Mumbai is the peninsular portion of city, representing the "city" within the Greater Mumbai area, as opposed to the "suburbs" further north.

South Mumbai (Churchgate, Colaba, Malabar Hill, Marine Lines)

One of the affluent residential areas in Old Mumbai, and is considered the heart of this commercial capital of India. The richest neighbourhoods in the country are here, which command among the highest property rates in the world. Real estate prices here are comparable to those in Manhattan. This is the primary tourist district of Mumbai and home to most of the city's bars, upscale restaurants and the Gateway of India.

Fort

The old business district of Mumbai, and home to the  UNESCO World Heritage Site of the Victorian Gothic and Art Deco Ensembles of Mumbai.

Elephanta

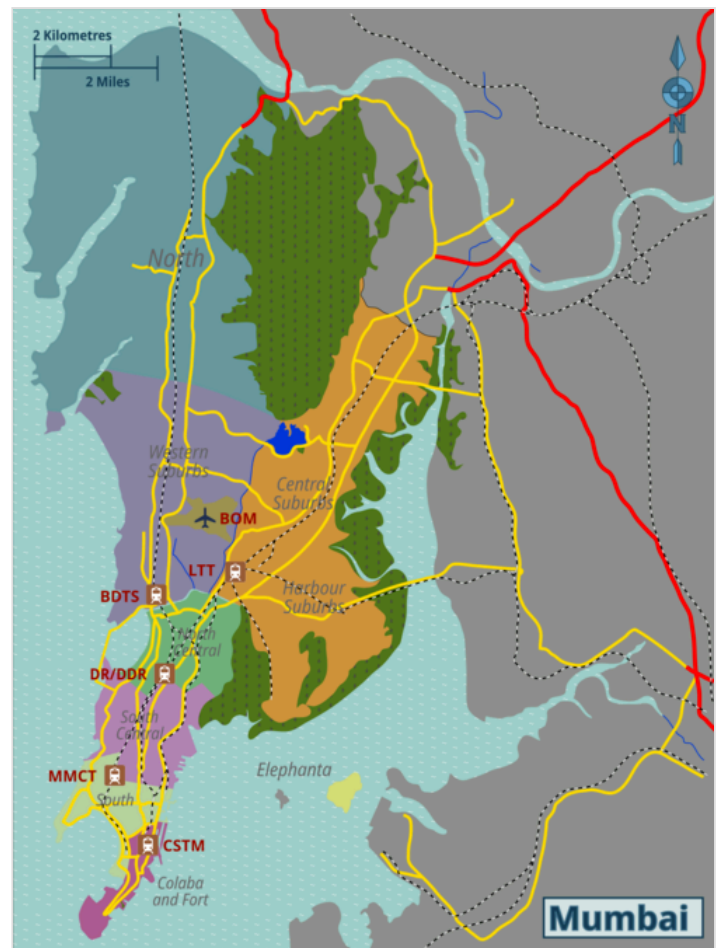
Check out the fine examples of rock sculptures dedicated to Shiva on a remote island. Even though many of them have been vandalised by Portuguese invaders, their grandeur has hardly been diminished. The island has two groups of caves in the rock-cut architectural style. The caves are hewn from solid basalt rock.

South Central Mumbai (Kalbadevi, Pydhonie, Cumballa Hill, Tardeo, Grant Road, Mahalaxmi, Sandhurst Road, Byculla, Chinchpokli)

Home to Mumbai's only zoo, and the temple to what people consider the city's guardian deity.

North Central Mumbai (Lower Parel, Prabhadevi, Worli, Dadar, Mahim, Currey Road, Parel, Matunga, Sion, Chunabhatti, Sewri, Wadala, GTB Nagar, King's Circle)
Used to be Mumbai's industrial heartland, but went into decline when the industries did. Now this area has been revamped into a white-collar office location. It's primarily an upper-middle-class district, except for Dharavi, which contains Asia's second largest slum.

railway line. For example, Mulund West means that the area is to the west of Mulund railway station. In addresses, West and East are abbreviated, e.g. Mulund (W) and Mulund (E).



Mumbai regions - Color-coded map — [switch to interactive map](#)

Suburbs

The **suburbs** covered in this article fall within the municipal limits of Greater Mumbai since the 1940s. Suburbs further north and east are covered in the North Konkan region.

Western Suburbs (Bandra, Khar, Santacruz, Juhu, Vile Parle, Andheri)

Home to those who want to have a more peaceful surrounding. It has a few beaches and promenades. Home to a large Christian community and the city's most famous church.

Eastern Suburbs (Kurla, Vidyavihar, Ghatkopar, Vikhroli, Kanjur Marg, Bhandup, Mulund, Powai, Chembur, Mankhurd, Govandi, Trombay)

A middle-class bastion. Mulund and Ghatkopar are home to a predominantly middle and upper-middle-class populace, many from the entrepreneurial Gujarati community.

North Mumbai (Manori, Jogeshwari, Borivali, Gorai, Dahisar)

Has some beaches that are not dirty. Other than this, it is just another victim of Mumbai's vast urban sprawl. Contains Mumbai's oldest heritage sites, as well as the "Film City" that defined Bollywood.

Sanjay Gandhi National Park (Kanheri Caves, Tulsi Lake, Yeoor Hills)

The lungs of Mumbai; famous for its leopards and the caves inside the park.

Understand

Mumbai is a bustling, diverse metropolis with a flair of its own. The entrepreneurial spirit and pulsing pace of life provide a sharp contrast to much of the rest of India.

Name

There has been much debate regarding the original name of the city. Some say the current name of the city Mumbai is the original name; and is an eponym derived from *Mumbā*, the name of the local Hindu goddess Mumbadevi, and *āī*, meaning "mother" in Marathi. Others claim Bombay was an anglicised version of Bom Bahia, a name given by the Portuguese to mean "Beautiful Bay" and later made popular by the British as the name of the Bombay state.



Carvings at the Elephanta Caves



The name was officially changed from Bombay to Mumbai in 1995. Although both Bombay and Mumbai are common, people who explicitly use "Bombay" are generally non-Marathi speakers whereas "Mumbai" proponents primarily speak Marathi. In the West, Mumbai has become more commonly accepted in order to avoid controversy. The city is also fondly called *āmcī Mumbāī* (आमची मुंबई, "our Mumbai").

History

Though the seven islands that now make up the city have a long recorded history like any other place in India, their journey to form the city of Mumbai really started in 1498, when the Portuguese took them over from the Sultan of Gujarat. They built a settlement, forts, and churches (including the strange-looking Portuguese Church that stands to this day). However,

they could not make much of their possession and the seven islands were handed over to England in 1661 as part of the dowry of Catherine de Braganza when she married Charles II of England. He wasn't very interested in the islands either, and he leased them to the British East India Company for £10 a year in 1668. The East India Company built the docks, the trading posts, and the fort that would form the nerve centre of the city. They also started off the long process of reclaiming land and joining the islands, an activity which went on until the 1960s.

The port attracted industries, and the entrepreneurial communities like the Parsis, Gujaratis and Marwaris (from Rajasthan) migrated and set up trading companies and factories in the late 19th century. Industries attracted migrant labour from different parts of the country. The successive waves of migration shaped the character of the city and its neighbourhoods.

The city that owes its existence to the efforts of the British was also the birthplace of the Indian National Congress, which played an overwhelmingly important role in the independence movement. The city whose mills were built by industrialists from across the country is the capital of Maharashtra state, which was carved on linguistic lines for Marathi speakers.

In the 1980s, high labour costs and unrest forced the closure of many textile mills and the city went into a decline from which it started recovering only in the late 1990s. The high population put a strain on the infrastructure. The rail and road network underwent a steady improvement over the 1990s, but because of the magnitude of the task, the roads seemed to be perennially under construction. Mumbai has now reinvented itself as a hub for the service industry.

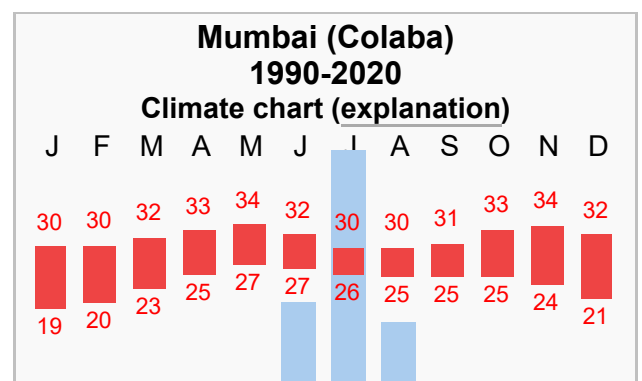
In January 1993, in the wake of the destruction of the Babri Mosque in Ayodhya, a wave of riots swept the city, with over 1,000 people killed, the vast majority of whom were Muslims. Relations between the city's various ethnic groups have been tense ever since, with several terrorist outrages (see #Stay safe) adding fuel to the fire.

Culture and attitudes

Mumbai is the most cosmopolitan city in India. In comparison with the rest of the country, the city is quite liberal. With a regular influx of immigrants from the rest of India, the citizens, popularly known as 'Mumbaikars', have shown remarkable tolerance towards other cultures, making it a true cultural melting pot. However this tolerance has sometimes bowed under external pressures. Between the 60s and 80s, there was resentment about the non-Marathi speakers taking away jobs. The 1991 and 1993 riots between Hindus and Muslims did affect this spirit; however, the city managed to recover from these, once again proudly highlighting true 'spirit of Mumbai'.

Climate

Mumbai has three main seasons: summer, monsoon, and winter (milder summer). The best time to visit is during the winter between October and February. Humidity is also less during the winter, when the climate is pleasant; the minimum temperature is 17°C and the maximum is 30–31 °C (86–88 °F). Summer is from March to May, with highs in the low to mid 30s (roughly



80–90°F). It is hot and humid during this time. June to September is the monsoon season when the city is lashed by heavy rains. The city gets flooded two or three times and normal life gets disrupted during this season. Climate is humid pretty much throughout the year because the city rests on the coast.

Visitor information

Official websites:

- [Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation \(https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/\)](https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/) (BMC), also known as the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai (MCGM)
- [Mumbai City District \(https://mumbaicity.gov.in/en/\)](https://mumbaicity.gov.in/en/), covers the Old Mumbai area
- [Mumbai Suburban District \(https://mumbaisuburban.gov.in/en/\)](https://mumbaisuburban.gov.in/en/), covers the suburbs

Get in

By plane

Mumbai has excellent connectivity with most of the major cities around the world, including [New York](#), [London](#), [Dubai](#), [Singapore](#), [Hong Kong](#) and [Kuala Lumpur](#) to name a few. If you are flying from Europe it is generally cheaper to fly from London, and there are many frequent flights available. All domestic sectors are linked to Mumbai, making it the second busiest hub in the country next to Delhi.

- **1 Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (BOM^{IATA})**. One of India's busiest airports and one of the main international gateways to the country. Many international airlines and low-cost carriers fly into Mumbai. (updated Mar 2026 |)
- **2 Navi Mumbai International Airport (https://navimumbai.adaniairports.com/) (NMI^{IATA})**, Navi Mumbai. A new airport, opened in 2025. As of April 2026, it serves only domestic destinations, making it a good alternative to Mumbai-Shivaji for domestic flights. International flights are scheduled to roll out before the end of the year. (updated May 2026 |)

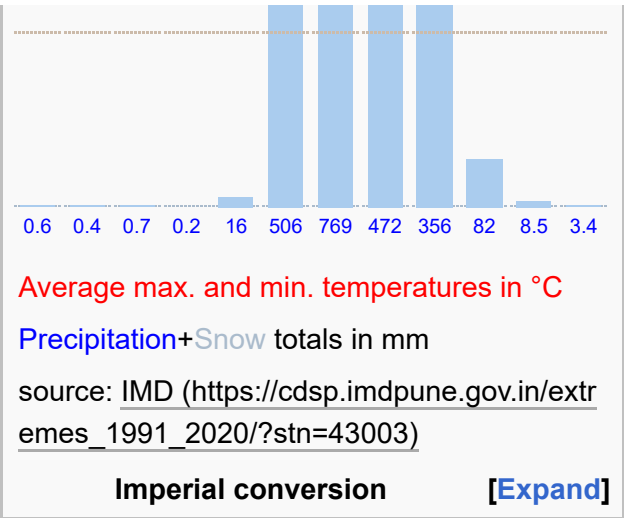


Interior of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (International Terminal)

By boat

Thane Creek is bustling with ferries to central Mumbai from various cities on the southern and eastern side of the creek, such as [Alibag](#). Ferries from Ferry Wharf also allow cheap access to islands and beaches in the vicinity of the city and [Elephanta](#).

There are no scheduled international ferries to Mumbai, however cruise ships dock regularly.



By train

See also: [Rail travel in India](#)

Hundreds of trains arrive daily from all over India, almost all major cities have a direct connection with Mumbai. Trains terminate at various different stations throughout the vast city, so make sure to note which station is relevant for your journey.

Main reservation offices are at Churchgate, Mumbai Central and Bandra Terminus for the Western line, and Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus, Dadar Central and Lokmanya Tilak Terminus on the Central line. There are unique ticket windows and quotas for foreign tourists. Bookings and tariffs on train tickets from anywhere in India from Mumbai can be found at the website of **Indian Railways** (<http://www.indianrail.gov.in/>). Notice that while all trains are operated by Indian Railways, the Western and Central Lines function independently and reservations can only be made at certain stations.

The private luxury service **Maharajas' Express** (<http://www.the-maharajas.com/>) has travel packages between Mumbai and [Delhi](#). A high-speed railway from Ahmedabad is under construction and is planned to open in 2027.

Railways in India

The first commercial railway service began on 16th April 1853 at 3:35PM on its first run between Victoria Terminus (present-day CSMT) and Thane.



View of the exuberant Victorian Gothic façade of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus, a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

- **3 Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus** **CR** (station code: CSTM). Completed during the British Raj in 1888, this architectural masterpiece is a [UNESCO World Heritage Site](#) and worth a visit even if you are not catching a train. Formerly named **Victoria Terminus** it was renamed in 1996 to honour **Shivaji**, founder of the Maratha Empire. Most long-distance services from [Southern India](#), [Eastern India](#) and parts of Northern India terminate here. (updated Mar 2026 |)
- **4 Mumbai Central** **WR** (station code: MMCT). The other major railway terminus in central Mumbai, trains from [Western states](#) of [Gujarat](#), [Rajasthan](#) and some parts of Northern India terminate here. (updated Sep 2023 |)
- **5 Dadar** **WR CR** (station code: DR (Western) or DDR (Central)). Terminal for trains on the Konkan Railway, from Goa and Mangalore. (updated Sep 2023 |)
- **6 Lokmanya Tilak Terminus** **CR** (station code: LTT). Receives a number of trains which used to terminate at CSMT or Dadar Central. (updated Mar 2026 |)
- **7 Bandra Terminus** **WR** (station code: BDTS). Receives a number of trains which used to terminate at Mumbai Central. (updated Mar 2026 |)

By car

National highway numbers 3, 4, 6, 8, 9, 17, and the Mumbai-Pune expressway radiate from the city providing links to all parts of the country. The road conditions are generally better than in the rest of India. Distances from various cities to Mumbai are:

- **From other states:** Ahmedabad (524 km (326 mi), 10 hr), Bangalore (982 km (610 mi)), Chennai (1,334 km (829 mi)), Kochi (1,427 km (887 mi)), Goa (583 km (362 mi), 11 hr),

Hyderabad (711 km (442 mi), 14 hr), Mangalore (892 km (554 mi)), New Delhi (1,402 km (871 mi))

- **From Maharashtra State:** Amravati (669 km (416 mi)), Ahmednagar (254 km (158 mi)), Nagpur (824 km (512 mi)), Pune (151 km (94 mi), 2½–3 hr)

By bus

Mumbai is well served by buses from destinations inside India.

- **Asiad Bus Service** The bus terminal, popularly known as 'Asiad Bus Terminal' on Ambedkar Rd in Dadar east is another hub from where buses travel to Pune at regular frequency of 15 minutes to 1 hour. Buses vary in comfort from ordinary to luxury with airconditioning. Other routes available are Mumbai–Satara and Mumbai–Nasik. The easiest way to reach the terminal is to cross over using pedestrian foot bridge to Dadar East from the Dadar Terminus and walk straight all the way (less than 5 mins) to Ambedkar Rd.
- **Private Buses** There also exist numerous private bus operators who operate a large number of services from/to Mumbai from most major cities like Udaipur, Ajmer, Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Surat, Indore, Nashik, Aurangabad, Hyderabad, Belgaum, Hubli, Bangalore, Mangalore, Trichur and Goa. For Pune, buses depart every 10 minutes. Crawford Market, Dadar T.T., Sion, Chembur and Borivili are the main starting points. Some of the reliable private operators are - National, Neeta, Sharma, VRL, Konduskar, Dolphin, Paulo and Southern Travels.
- The comfortable air-conditioned blue cabs are available to Pune and Ahmednagar-Nashik from opposite Asiad Bus Terminal in Dadar and Lakhamshi Nappoo Rd near Dadar east railway station respectively.
- **ST Buses** (MSRTC (Maharashtra State Road Transport Corporation)), ☎ +91 22 2307 4272 (Mumbai Central), +91 22 2307 6622 (Mumbai Central), +91 22 2422 9905 (Parel), +91 22 2413 6835 (Dadar). Operates services to Mumbai from various cities in Maharashtra. Mumbai Central is the most important Terminus in the city. All major cities in Maharashtra and nearby states are connected through Mumbai Central Terminus. The other important ST depots are at Parel, Nehru Nagar-Kurla, and Borivali. You can get buses for all over Maharashtra from these depots. But from Mumbai Central you would get buses any time as well as other State Transport buses. Quality varies.

Get around

Most of Mumbai's inhabitants rely on public transport to and from their workplaces due to the lack of parking spaces, traffic bottlenecks and generally poor road conditions, especially in the monsoon. However, do ride in a taxi at least once in the city. Feel real adventure in a vehicle that feels like it might fall apart at speed with a driver who thinks he's Schumacher.

For travelling using public transport, you can download the m-Indicator app for Android (<http://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.mobond.mindicator>) and iPhone (<https://apps.apple.com/in/app/m-indicator/id593278253>). It contains useful information about bus and train routes, which can help you plan your commute.

By train

The **Mumbai Suburban Railway**, commonly referred to as "Locals", is both an icon and a vital artery of Mumbai and a ride on it should be on every visitor's agenda. There are three primary lines in the city center — the Western Line, the Central Line and the Harbour Line. Combined, the network carries a staggering 9 million people daily.

- Mumbai is a linear city and the **Western Line** **Western** travels from Churchgate to Dahanu Road via Mumbai's Western Suburbs. The Western line provides north–south connectivity.
- The **Central Line** **Central** travels from Mumbai CSMT to Ambernath via Mumbai's Central Suburbs and Thane, with some services running beyond to Karjat, Khopoli, and Kasara. The interchange point between the Western Line and the Central Line is Dadar.
- The **Harbour Line** **Harbour** has a common stretch between Mumbai CSMT and Vadala Road. The Harbour Line splits into two spurs, the main one running to Mumbai's Eastern Suburbs and Navi Mumbai, up to Panvel. The Interchange point of this line with the Central Main Line is at Kurla. The other spur of the Harbour Line runs up to Mahim on the Western Line and runs parallel up to Andheri. The interchange stations with the Western line are Bandra and Andheri.



Map of the Mumbai Metro and Suburban Railways



A typical "local". Note the open doors.

Ticket prices start from ₹5 in second class (Class II) and ₹50 in first class (Class I). The carriages are largely identical, but the first-time rider is still well advised to pay the 10x extra, since second class gets packed like sardines if it's even remotely close to rush hour. The fleet is gradually being air-conditioned, but there are still plenty of non-air-con trains about. These often run with the doors open, so don't be a statistic: over 2,000 people are killed on the rails in Mumbai every year.

There would always be queues and it would be advisable to buy coupon booklets. Coupon booklet punching machines are available at all stations and the best thing is you will not have to stand in a huge line to buy a booklet. Another option is to buy a Smart card for Railways. It helps you maintain balance like any gift card with an option to refill it once it goes below the limit. Smart card outlets to buy tickets are available at all stations. They are touch screen based and you can simply follow the instructions to buy a ticket for the right path.

If you are a tourist, you can buy a 'Tourist Ticket'. It costs ₹275 and you can travel in first class compartments of all three lines during the entire day. Ensure the location of the first-class compartment before the train arrives. You may ask fellow passengers or the vendors at the various food stalls. An easier way to spot the location of the First class compartment is to check the station walls painted with red and yellow slant stripes.

Trains on all lines start running after 4AM and end between midnight and 1AM. Avoid using local trains during rush hour (first class or otherwise). Rush hour is 8:30–10:30AM towards CST and Churchgate and 5:30PM–8:30PM in the opposite direction. If you are travelling during rush hour, don't stand near the railway tracks as you will get swamped by frantic. Take no offence if you are pushed and shoved about, as passengers jostle for a spot. As you near your exit station, ensure that you are as close as possible to the train door, as experienced commuters, will begin the mad run to be first on, or off, the car before the car comes to a full stop. If you stand any

chance of getting on/off before the train departs, you must be equally aggressive in your focus to exit/enter, remember no one will take offence if you make contact with others, as you wriggle by. Last, but not least, exiting/entering a train before it comes to a full stop is not something to be taken lightly, one misstep can send a person onto the rails with amazing ease! Leave the stunts to the experienced locals.

There are special coaches for women in both classes. These are designated by green and yellow slant stripes, spot these stripes on the station walls and you'll know where the *ladies* compartment is. These are generally less crowded and safer. But very late at night, it might actually be safer to travel by the general coach than the first-class women's coach, as the latter may be absolutely empty except for you. From 11:15PM-6:30PM the *ladies* compartment towards the northern end is open to the general public. Sometimes they have a cop guarding the coaches, but sometimes they won't. Use your judgement.



Inside a "local" outside rush hour



By metro

The modern Mumbai Metro is expanding rapidly and offers by far the most comfortable rides in the city. Line 3 (<https://mmrcl.com/>) (Aqua), in particular, connects the airport to business centre Bandra-Kurla Complex (BKC) and onward all the way to the southernmost tip of Mumbai at Colaba, making this very handy for visitors. Line 1 connects Andheri East and West and Ghatkopar West very well. Line 2A runs through the western parts of the Western Suburbs, and line 7 eastern part of Western Suburbs both till Andheri.



Mumbai Metro



While there is talk of unified ticketing, for time being each of the three metro operators has its own ticketing and app systems. Fares range from ₹10-70 depending on distance.

Mumbai also has India's first monorail line, connecting the eastern suburbs in Chembur to the south central areas of Wadala and South Mumbai. The fares range from ₹10-40 depending on the distance.

By bus

The Mumbai Metropolitan Region around Mumbai is fast developing into a major conurbation. If you need to get to the surrounding cities of Thane, Navi Mumbai or Kalyan, bus services are available.

Buses run from 5AM to midnight. Selected routes run beyond these timings, but much less often. The average frequency between buses ranges from five to 30 min depending on the route. Fares are reasonable and buses can be travelled during peak hours, unlike trains which are far too crowded. Some trunk routes do get extremely crowded, however. Peak hours also have traffic snarls which may depend on the area traversed and the state of the roads.

Buses are numbered and the final destination is marked on the front in Marathi and on the side in English. Generally, buses around the city and trunk routes would be in the 1–199 series. Buses in the western suburbs would be the 200 series while those plying in the central and eastern suburbs would be in the 300 and 400 series. Services to Navi Mumbai are in the 500 series and buses to the Mira-Bhayander area are in the 700 series.

What connects *Electric supply* and Transport?

BEST got into transport by starting a tram company. Now, of course, it runs buses that run on diesel & CNG, not electricity. The company is still in charge of electricity distribution for South and Central Mumbai.

- **Brihanmumbai Electric Supply and Transport (<http://www.bestundertaking.com>) (BEST)** provides efficient and comprehensive services connecting all places of the city and the suburbs. Some services also link the city with the extended suburbs like Navi Mumbai and Thane. Seats are almost always occupied. There are bus stops all over the city. There is usually a crowd and queue. You have to get in through the rear entrance and off at the front. Tickets are issued by a uniformed "conductor" after you get in. Special seats are marked for "Ladies", "Senior Citizens", "Handicapped", "Expectant Women", and "Women with infants". They can get in from the front. BEST has introduced the "Daily Pass" (Cost ₹50, valid on all BEST non-AC buses; Cost ₹60, valid on all BEST buses, including Air-conditioned bus routes). BEST has launched its app "**BEST Prawas** (<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.dimts.bestapplication>)" for Android, which contains features like live tracking of buses and ETA of buses. You can also purchase BEST bus tickets and passes using the **ridlr** (<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.ridlr>) app for Android.
- **TMT** (Thane Municipal Transport) operates services in the Thane city and areas around it.
- The **MSRTC** (Maharashtra State Road Transport Corporation), commonly known as ST, operates services from selected points in the city to the extended suburbs. From Dadar, services to Navi Mumbai and Panvel and from Borivali to Thane are the most prominent. Numerous other important routes are also covered in the MMR (Mumbai Metropolitan Region) by the MSRTC.
- **NMMT** (Navi Mumbai Municipal Transport) operates services in Navi Mumbai Area, and a few points around. They also have services from Mulund in Greater Mumbai.
- **KDMT** (Kalyan Dombivali Municipal Transport) operates in the Kalyan-Dombivli Area with a few connections to Navi Mumbai.

Another option is to book bus tickets online from **Redbus** (<http://www.redbus.in/>), which has a number of large private bus operators all over India.

By taxi

There are several types of taxis plying in Mumbai. You can hail a cab off the streets. Virtually all taxis have electronic meters which are somewhat tamper-proof. A taxi driver cannot refuse a fare as per law. If a driver

Farewell to an icon

Once upon a time, there used to be a fleet of Premier Padmini taxis plying around in Mumbai. They were fondly called "Kaali-Peelii" for their distinctive black

does refuse, a threat to complain to the nearest cop usually does the trick. The minimum fare for 1 mi (1.6 km) or less is ₹28 (in 2022).

A lot of tourists and locals alike use services like Uber and Ola Cabs to commute in and around Mumbai. Make sure to read the tariffs in these before you pay. While most of these services do accept cash, a lot of them can also be linked to online wallet (UPI) services like Paytm; as such, overcharging is rarely a risk.

Follow the queue system to board a taxi. Quite frequently, tourists and new visitors are mobbed by unscrupulous taxi drivers. Most drivers are honest, but the dishonest ones tend to cluster around railway stations and airports where they can more easily find suckers. Unless you are taking a prepaid taxi, always ask taxis to go by the meter. At the start of the journey, ensure that the meter is visible and shows the flag-down fare/meter reading.

If you have extra pieces of luggage, the boot (trunk) of the taxi will not provide sufficient space: one large suitcase is all that will fit there. Hiring a taxi with a top carrier will be better. Top carriers can accommodate up to three large suitcases. Before starting the journey, ensure that the luggage is securely fastened to the carrier.

Generally, the only way to call for a standard taxi is to hail one on the street. This will not be a problem if you are within Old Mumbai or Bandra. It will be difficult to find a taxi in the suburbs as they have been out-competed by the cheaper auto-rickshaws there.

The maximum number of passengers allowed for a trip officially is four — three in the back seat and one in the front. Seat belts are not mandatory for taxi passengers and most standard black and yellow taxis will not even have them installed, though expect them in the branded ones.

Air-conditioned taxis

Air-conditioned taxis are premium public taxis and their fare is 20% higher than non-air-conditioned taxis. These taxis are really helpful for tourists and travellers who are not accustomed to the heat and pollution of Mumbai. All the rules of non-air-conditioned taxis apply to air-conditioned taxis too.

Since the fare of air-conditioned taxis is at a premium, they are primarily used by tourists and business travellers. For the lack of demand, lack of supply is also expected. These taxis ply frequently but are not easily available in all locations. You can always expect them to be available at tourist hot spots like railway stations, airports, premium hotels, top tourist spots, etc. Where you don't find one, you can opt for a "private" taxi instead, see below.

and yellow colour. Sadly, the iconic taxis of the city were phased out by October 2023. However, you may still find these vehicles in the form of private cars and not as taxis.



Mumbai's famous "Kaali-Peeeli" taxis



An air-conditioned taxi



Private taxis

If you want a comfortable, air-conditioned ride at a surcharge of 25% over normal taxis, it's best to travel by **branded cab services** that operate at government-approved tariffs. These services operate in modern fleets with well-trained drivers. You can get them at 30–60 minutes' notice. They are clean, air-conditioned, equipped with digital, tamper-proof meters, punctual, honest, and GPS-equipped and -monitored, which makes them far secure at any time. If you're using a mobile phone, you receive an SMS with the driver's name, mobile number and car number 30 minutes before the scheduled departure. There is an additional 25% night surcharge (midnight to 5AM). Some can be booked online.

Tourist traps

One of the common scams is to charge the night fare rate during the daytime. You should be careful and read the heading before paying. In some cards, the night fare is red in colour and the daytime fare is black in colour.

The night charges are only applicable if you board the vehicle during the night hours (midnight to 5 AM). If you boarded the vehicle before midnight, and your journey is finishing after midnight, you are not liable to pay night charges. Similarly, if you board the vehicle before 5 AM and you finish after 5 AM, you are liable to pay night charges.

Sometimes, auto-rickshaw drivers charge the taxi fare and even show you a tariff card which is used for taxi fare computation.

You can download the m-indicator app which is available in Google Play Store and iTunes App Store. This app carries the latest taxi fares, auto fares, bus services details and local train timetables.

By auto-rickshaw

Auto-rickshaws are only allowed to operate beyond Bandra and Sion. They are not issued the licence for Old Mumbai. If you are not used to Indian roads, an auto-rickshaw ride can be heart-stopping, death-defying, laws-of-physics-bending.

Before departing, ensure that the meter is visible and shows the flag-down reading as 1.00 (on a mechanical meter). If the number is higher, insist that the driver flags it down once again. The minimum fare is ₹26 (in 2025). The meter remains at 1.00 for the first 1.6 km (0.99 mi) and every 0.10 movement indicates approx 200 m (i.e. 1.50 for every 0.2 km (0.12 mi)). Every auto driver is supposed to carry a valid RTO-approved meter tariff card. You can check this tariff card before paying. The meter also keeps ticking if you are waiting or are stuck in traffic. It's quite handy to have a copy of the meter card issued by The Mumbai Traffic Police. All of this applies to mechanical meters, not digital meters. Newer digital meters have started becoming common from 2012 onwards, and they show the exact fare, so there is no need to convert via the tariff card.



An auto-rickshaw in suburban Mumbai

Auto-rickshaws are slower than cars and have terrible suspensions. Pregnant ladies are most *strongly advised* not to travel by auto-rickshaws since the combination of rash driving, poor suspensions, and horrible road conditions have quite often led to serious complications. The auto-rickshaw is a slow and uncomfortable vehicle and is not recommended for very long distances.

By ferry

These are a few intra-city ferry services:

- **Gateway of India to Elephanta Caves** Fast boats and Catamarans operated by private operators. These are moderately priced. This is only way to get to Elephanta Caves.
- **Gorai (Borivali) to Gorai Beach** Low-cost ferry connecting Gorai Beach/Esselworld.
- **Marve Jetty (Malad) to Manori Jetty** Cheap ferry (by BEST) connecting Manori and Gorai. Also services for Esselworld (Amusement Park).
- **Versova (Andheri) to Madh Jetty** Cheap ferry connecting Madh/Erangal/Aksa/Marve.

By car

Travel agents and hotels can arrange private chauffeur-driven cars to provide services. Expensive by comparison with taxis, they are the most trusted, secure, and comfortable way to travel around the city. Driving in Mumbai can be difficult, because of poor driver discipline, but chauffeur-driven services are very reasonable. These can be arranged by travel companies or online from the countries of origin. Car rental agencies also have services in Mumbai.

Talk

Mumbai is India's melting pot — a confluence of people from various parts of India, but dominant are people from the west, then north, and followed by the south. **Marathi** is the state and city official language used by State Government agencies, municipal authorities, and the local police, and also the first language of most locals.

However, being one of India's largest cities and main commercial centre, Mumbai is now also home to migrants from other parts of India who do not speak Marathi. A local variant of **Hindi**, with strong Bollywood influence, called *Mumbaiya Hindi* (or *Bambaiya Hindi*), serves as the lingua franca. Although almost everyone can understand standard Hindi, you may get an interesting reply from some. Most educated locals will be well versed in Marathi, Hindi and English.

English is widely used in the corporate world and in banking and trading. In most places, you will be able to get by with Hindi and English, as most people you will encounter can communicate in broken English at the very least. However, expect to hear more regional languages including Tamil and Gujarati, in areas where population from these states are higher.

See

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

There is a lot to see in Mumbai, but the typical "tourist" sights are concentrated in South Mumbai.

By Indian standards, Mumbai is a young city and much of the land comprising the city did not exist until it was claimed from the sea over three centuries ago. It is therefore a pleasant surprise to find rock cut caves such as the Elephanta, Kanheri, and Mahakali within city limits.

Colonial buildings

The British built a magnificent city within the walls of Fort St. George, which lies at the southern extremity of the city. Some fine examples of the Gothic revival, Neo-classical style and Indo-Saracenic style are seen within this area. To get the best experience of the city centre, stroll around the wide streets of the area right from Churchgate to Colaba. These areas are all beautifully planned and have wide and clean pavements, unlike the rest of the city. Famous monuments to be seen in this area are the Gateway of India, the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus (CSMT, previously Victoria Terminus), the Municipal Corporation and Police Headquarters and the Chhatrapati Shivaji Vastu Sanghralaya (formerly, the Prince Of Wales Museum). The famous Taj Mahal Palace Hotel is opposite the Gateway of India. The Mumbai University buildings and the High Court are also excellent examples of colonial architecture in the city.

There are a lot of other modern structures to look at in this area. The area known as Marine Drive (right from Girgaon Chowpatty to NCPA) is home to a large number of buildings built in the Art Deco style. Mumbai is second only to Miami in the number of Art Deco buildings. Some famous buildings in this style are the Eros and Regal cinemas. The Art Deco and Gothic buildings were added to the UNESCO World Heritage List in 2018.

Museums and galleries

Some of the India's most famous museums and art galleries are found here. The Kala Ghoda area in South Mumbai teems with them, particularly the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (<http://www.csmvs.in>) (Prince of Wales Museum), and the National Gallery of Modern Art (http://ngmaindia.gov.in/ngma_

The game of names

The names of Mumbai's monuments tell us the story of which way political winds were blowing when they were built. In the late 19th century the British named everything after their Queen, so we had Victoria Terminus, Victoria Gardens and Victoria Jubilee Technical Institute (built in 1887 to commemorate the 50th anniversary of Her Majesty's coronation). In the early 20th century, they named everything after the Prince of Wales.

After India's independence, the colonial names could not be retained of course, so they were renamed. Depending on whether the city was suffering from bouts of nationalistic pride or Marathi pride at that time, they were named after either Jawaharlal Nehru (the first Prime Minister of India) or Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (who founded the Maratha Empire in the 17th century). Often, they were named after Shivaji's mother, Jijabai. The advantage of this was that using Veermata Jijabai ("courageous mother Jijabai") for a place that was earlier named for Victoria maintains the same abbreviation, so "Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute" (formerly Victoria Jubilee Technical Institute) is still VJTI.

For a traveller, the practical problem would be that many places have multiple names. Multiple places are named after Nehru, Shivaji or Jijabai, so you

[mumbai.asp](#)). Once again, most of them are concentrated in South Mumbai. Also worth planning a visit is Jehangir Art Gallery, also at Kala Ghoda, displays changing exhibits by notable artists. The plaza next to the gallery also regularly displays exhibits of various artists.

In Nehru Complex in Worli is Nehru Centre Art Gallery at Worli is a gallery dedicated to young and promising talent along with established artists. Also within the complex is a permanent exposition, Discovery of India, which attempts to cover every aspect of artistic, intellectual and philosophical attainment of India through ages. The exposition spreads across 14 galleries and reflects true identity of the country. On the other end of the complex, Nehru Science Centre - which has a separate entrance from Mahalaxmi race course road, has a permanent exhibition on 'interactive and exciting' science related exhibits highlighting science principles in fun yet educational way.

Beaches

Mumbai isn't known for beaches because they have immensely filthy water! Mumbai has a few beaches, including one in the southern districts. But they aren't that great and the water off Mumbai's coast is extraordinarily dirty. The relatively better ones are in North Mumbai. However, they are a great place to see how the locals spend their Sunday evenings, with various food and game stalls.

There are other beaches to be found such as the Girgaon Chowpatty (the cleanest one) in South Mumbai, Juhu Beach in the Western Suburbs and Aksa Beach in North Mumbai. The currents don't seem strong, but particularly in the rains, lots of people die from drowning, so avoid getting in the water (especially at Aksa Beach). A word of advice to women: Mumbai beaches are not the kind you can wear swimsuits to, particularly two-pieces.

Zoos, parks and gardens

Mumbai has a justified reputation as a concrete jungle, but there are some nice pockets of greenery within the city. It is also one of the rare megacities to have an entire national park within its borders (Sanjay Gandhi National Park). You may not visit Mumbai for them, but if you are already here, they make a nice escape from the din and bustle. It also houses the ancient Kanheri Caves crafted out of rocky cliffs, which dates back 2,400 years.

The city zoo (**Jijamata Udyan**) in Byculla is a colonial relic and it is surprisingly well-preserved. The animals may look rather emaciated, but the sheer diversity of trees on this lush zoo is worth a trip.

need to be careful about specifying which place you need to get to.

A few important names changes to remember are:

- 'Victoria Terminus' is now 'Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus'
- 'Jacob Circle' is now 'Saat Rasta' or 'Sant Gadge Maharaj Chowk'
- 'King's Circle' is now 'Maheshwari Udyan'
- 'Kurla Terminus' is now 'Lokmanya Tilak Terminus'



Bombay High Court, a Victorian Gothic building



Some city parks are very well-maintained and combine history as well. The **Hanging Gardens** on the Malabar Hill offers stunning vistas of the Marine Drive. Opposite the Hanging Gardens, there is another park which is known as Kamala Nehru Park, famous for the striking shoe-shaped structure which has been filmed in various Bollywood movies

Further in South Mumbai, the Mumbai Port Trust Garden, is another hidden gem. This is set off a small side street off the Colaba Causeway 2–3 km (1.2–1.9 mi) south of the main section. Attractive views of the port, the naval yards and sunset.

In North Central Mumbai, there is Mancherji Joshi Five Gardens. Mainly used by walkers in the morning, it is a mess in the evenings. But the gardens encircle some historic, art deco residences.

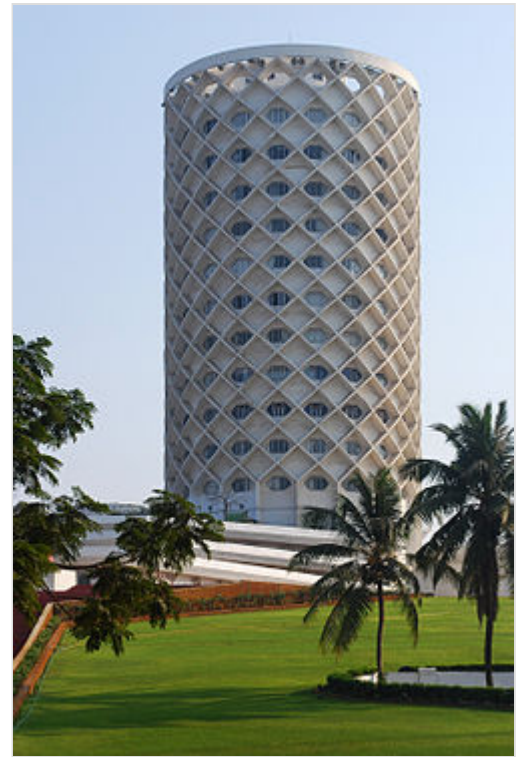
Markets and crowds

Mumbai is probably worth visiting just for its street markets, the hustle of vendors, and the madness of the crowds. Good places are Bandra, Khar and Andheri. If you came to Mumbai and didn't give visit to the highly dense and crowded markets, it means you didn't meet the real Mumbai.

Hawkers and street shoppers don't ask for any legal permission and then set their stalls at the places where they see maximum footfall. From electronics items to fresh food, you can get everything at railway platforms, subway and mains streets.

Modern buildings and malls

Once the British left, the zeal to wipe away the traces of colonial rule was, unfortunately, not matched by the enthusiasm to build a new city that matched the grandeur of the British-era buildings. Now, while the shabbiness of the socialist era is thankfully being replaced by architecture with an eye on aesthetics, the new malls, multiplexes, and office buildings that are coming up are indistinguishable from those anywhere else in the world. Still, they are worth a look, especially if you want to have a look at India's success story. Skyscrapers exceeding 60 stories now dominate the skyline.



Nehru Science Centre



Faluda stall at Juhu Beach



Sanjay Gandhi National Park



For long, Inorbit Mall was the only mall offering a lot of variety for shoppers. Palladium, built within the High Street Phoenix, broke the monopoly of Inorbit Mall. From state of the art interiors to international brands, the Palladium has everything. The new Infiniti Mall (Infinity 2) in Malad also has lots of foreign brands and is one of the biggest malls in the suburbs. Nirmal Lifestyles Mall in Mulund and Metro Junction Mall in Kalyan are two of the largest malls in Mumbai. In the central suburbs, they are quite popular in the city. The **Phoenix Marketcity Mall** (<https://www.phoenixmarketcity.com/mumbai>) is the largest in the city, located in Kurla. There is also the R CITY Mall in Ghatkopar.



Dharavi slum



Powai is a modern central Mumbai suburb with European looks. Powai houses the Indian Institute of Technology and is built around fabulous lake. Most of the construction is in a township format and is privately built. It houses twenty top of the line restaurants, two large convenience stores, a handful of coffee shops and entertainment areas. Initially built as an upmarket self-contained township, Powai has now grown into a business process outsourcing hub in Mumbai. The township reflects both characteristics; you will often find families shopping and twenty somethings hanging out in tables next to each other.

Religious places

Mumbai has temples, mosques, churches, Parsi agiaries, and even a few synagogues reflecting the diversity of its citizens. While these are naturally of interest if you are a believer, some, like the Portuguese church at Dadar are worth visiting just for their unique architecture.

Mahalaxmi temple is located on the shores of the Arabian Sea, offering a scenic and serene view to the devotees and visitors.

Siddhivinayak temple of Mumbai is very famous. It is in Dadar and you can easily get a taxi to go to the temple from the Dadar railway station.

The city also boasts of Jewish places of worship predominantly in the area called Byculla, but also in South Mumbai. In this area the three prominent Jewish groups of Mumbai lived. They were Baghdadi Jews, Bene Israelis and the locals who had converted over a period of time and lived in the hinterland.

There are two very beautiful Hare Krishna (ISKCON) temples that are significant tourist attractions. One is in Hare Krishna land, Juhu, Andheri and the other in South Mumbai, near Gandhi's house. Both have Govinda's pure vegetarian restaurants at the premises. Most tourists appreciate the peaceful experience in the temple.

The Islamic Research Foundation of Zakir Naik is in South Central Mumbai near Dongri. Is popular with people of all faiths. It hosts a vast library of books from all world religions and is a great place to hangout and know about Islamic culture.

Mount Mary Church, also known as Basilica of Our Lady of the Mount, is a Roman Catholic church located in Bandra West.

Haji Ali Dargah is one of the most visited places in Mumbai. The dargah is built on a tiny islet 500 metres from the coast, in the middle of Worli Bay, in the vicinity of Worli. People from different religion and places visit this places. More than 80,000 people visit dargah every week.

One notable monument in North Mumbai is the Global Vipassana Pagoda in Gorai. It is a meditation centre that can seat 8,000 people. Vipassana literally means mediation, and the centre runs 10-day meditation courses and 1 day mega courses on Sundays. The courses are free of cost but you would have to register for them in advance on their website.

Do

There is a lot to do in Mumbai, but lack of space means that for outdoorsy activities, you need to head north, often outside city limits. In North Mumbai and Thane, you will find opportunities for water sports like H2O at Girgaon Chowpatty. There are two golf courses in the city, the more famous one is in Chembur in the Harbour Suburbs.



Marine Drive



Mumbai has a vibrant theatre scene with plays in many languages including English, Hindi, Gujarati, and Marathi. While South Mumbai has frequent performances, the best organised theatre effort is at Prithvi theatre, Juhu in the Western Suburbs. There are plenty of opportunities to enjoy Indian classical music and dance. While not a patch on the *Sabhas* of Chennai, you will find frequent performances of Carnatic music in Shanmukhananda Hall, Matunga in North Central Mumbai. Check newspapers on latest shows as well as performances at prominent halls

Mumbai is also usually the first stop for Western pop and rock stars visiting India, which they usually do when they are over 50. The Rock scene is very good in Mumbai. These are very safe to go to and are recommended for rock fans. Most bands cover heavy metal acts like Pantera, Six feet under, and Slipknot. To try to find places with specific music tastes try asking students outside Mumbai's colleges.

Western classical music performances are rarer. However most classical music performances along with other art forms are regularly performed at NCPA (<http://www.ncpamumbai.com/>) and Tata Theatre (<http://ncpamumbai.com/venue/tata-theatre>), both next to the narrow strip at Nariman Point.

- **Chowpatty Jayenge Bhel Puri Khayenge**; as it says in the lyrics of one of the Bollywood movie song, go to beaches (specially in the evenings) and enjoy local favourite 'Bhel Puri' while the sun sets in the Arabian sea.
- **Take a harbour cruise**; cruises from Gateway of India leave every 30 min daily except during the monsoon season (Jun-Sep). You can also rent the Taj's private yacht (has two sun decks and three bedrooms) for a cruise around the Mumbai Harbour if you can afford one.
- **Get crowded**, and try catching suburban trains at peak times. You are warned though.
- **Dabba wallahs** are a group of couriers in Mumbai who move two million household lunchboxes every day in a complicated system of delivery.
- **Join for heritage walks** (<http://www.bombayheritagewalks.com>). organised by two architects, these walks take you around various historic and architecturally significant areas

of the city. Walks are organised on the third Sunday of every month (with a break from June through August for the monsoons) and the route varies each time. The walks last around 2 hours. Discounted rates for students and the physically challenged.

- **Poonawallas Breeders Multimillion**; on the last Sunday of February, the glitterati of Mumbai dress up for the Ascot of Mumbai at the Mahalaxmi Race Course. With High Tea, amazing hats, and hundreds of ordinary punters staking their little all on the outside chance, this is the event to attend in Mumbai so try to cage a ticket if you happen to visit around then.
- **Pub Hopping**, The number and variety of Pubs in the city allow for an enthralling Pub Hopping opportunity.
- **Watch the sunset at the Gateway of India**
- **Watch a Movie**; you are in the land of Bollywood. Expect whistles and clapping by crowd in admiration of their celebrities on the screen, except at multiplexes as this occurs at single-screen movie theatres. Most of the cinema halls run both 'popular and new' Bollywood as well as Hollywood movies and some even screen ones in regional languages. Some of the popular Hollywood screening cinema halls in South Mumbai are Eros opposite Churchgate, Metro on M.G.Road, Regal in Colaba, Sterling next to CST Station, and New Excelsior in Fort. With the rise of malls and multiplexes, the nearest cinema is unlikely to be more than a stone's throw away, even in the suburbs. Check out newspaper listing to get the list of latest screenings.
- **Watch Cricket for Free**; cricket has a national games stature in India, and Mumbaikars revere that every day of the year. Azad Maidan (Azad ground) near Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus, ground opposite to Ruia College in Matunga and Shivaji Park in Dadar west are some of the best places to witness the cricket fever for free. You may be even lucky to witness ongoing game of cricket on some of the empty streets of Mumbai. Mumbai has its state league called the Mumbai T20 League. It is also home to the Mumbai team in the Ranji Trophy. Mumbai has the iconic Wankhede Stadium at Nariman Point and is home to the Mumbai Indians team in the Indian Premier League. Mumbai also has additional stadiums like Brabourne Stadium near Marine Lines. Brabourne Stadium hosts WPL matches is a backup in case Wankhede undergoes renovation etc. Wankhede also hosts international matches against England and Australia and New Zealand and Bangladesh and Sri Lanka and even World Cup matches. Book your tickets early and if you're a Mumbai Indians fan or just watching a match against national teams prepare for the roars when the stars walk in to play.

Events

While many religious festivals are celebrated by people in Mumbai, a few of these are essentially public and social occasions where travellers can participate.

- **Banganga Festival (<http://www.maharashtratourism.gov.in>)**. (Jan) The musical festival is organised by Maharashtra Tourism (MTDC) annually at Banganga Tank on Malabar Hill.
- **Elephanta Festival (<http://www.maharashtratourism.gov.in>)**. (March) Organised by Maharashtra Tourism, the festival of music and dance at Elephanta Caves has in the past seen performances by renowned artists like Alarmel Valli, Sanjeev Abhyankar, and Ananda Shankar and traditional Koli dances as well as traditional food. 7PM-10PM (Ferries start at 4PM)
- **Kala Ghoda Festival (<http://www.kalaghodaassociation.com/>)**. The arts and crafts festival is held in the last week of Jan or first week of Feb annually in the historic precinct of Kala ghoda in Mumbai.
- **Mumbai Festival** (Jan) Sample the vibrant culture of the city. The festival covers theater, sports, fashion, food, and shopping.
- **Mumbai Wine Fest** (Feb) Wine connoisseurs of the city gather to sample wines, enjoy the culinary delights while soaking in the cultural extravaganza put up at Kala Ghoda.

Religious festivals

- **Christmas** (Dec) This is characterised by midnight (nowadays held around 8–9PM on Christmas Eve due to restrictions on loud speakers) masses in churches and is usually followed by a number of private parties all across the city.
- **Diwali** (Oct/Nov) Festival of Lights. Start of New Year and opening of new accounts. Worshiping of Goddess Laxmi. Participate in the fireworks and view the bright lights.
- **Ganesh Chaturthi** (Aug/Sep) is one of Mumbai's most important and colourful festivals. During the 10 day celebration, Lord Ganesha is worshiped in millions of homes. See the colourful processions and participate in them, the biggest of which is on the last day of the celebrations where the largest idol is brought to Chowpatty for immersion in the wee-small hours of the morning and can vary depending on the crowd and pace of travel from Lal Bagh to the beach. The Lalbaug, Parel, Matunga and Dadar areas represent some of the best large scale decorations. On the last day of the festival, processions are carried out to bid bye to the loved deity in the sea. These presentations are colourful and carry a celebration fever. The best places to watch them are Girgaon and Dadar Chowpatty (beach) or the main roads such as Ambedkar Road from where the processions are carried out.
- **Janmashtami** (Jul/Aug) Birth Anniversary of Lord Krishna. Earthen pots full of curd are strung high up across the streets. Young men stand on top of one another to form a human pyramid and attempt to break the pots.
- **Mt. Mary's Feast** (Sep) The feast in honor of Our Lady of the Mount is celebrated with great solemnity at St. Mary's Church, Bandra. A week long Bandra fair is held during this time attracting huge crowds.
- **Navaratri** (Sep/Oct) is a 10-day festival, where nine of the nights are spent in worship and entire Mumbai swings to the rhythm of Garba and Raas dances of Gujarati community.
- **Eid al-Fitr** Muslim festival marks the end of the holy month of Ramadan. Marked by feasting at many places. Non-Muslims can also join in.

Sports

Mumbai inherits the cricket fever justifiably and the metropolitan region has 3 of the finest cricket stadiums in India, namely Brabourne Stadium (Churchgate), Wankhede Stadium (Marine Lines) and DY Patil Stadium (Navi Mumbai). Several of international cricket matches and domestic championships such as Indian Premier League (IPL) have been played in these stadiums. Watch out for upcoming cricket stadium to join the cricket frenzy crowd. Apart from these, Ruia College, Shivaji Park, Azad Maidan, Marine Lines are some of the places where live cricket action can be seen for free. Alternatively if you are a football fan, you may want to visit Cooperage Football ground (Colaba) for a local league match. For swimming enthusiasts, Mahatma Gandhi Swimming Pool (Dadar W) is the place to visit. For horse racing, head straight to Mahalakshmi Racecourse (Mahalaxmi). Powai hosts some of the finest Golf fields. For others there are many sport activities including lawn tennis, table tennis, badminton which can be practised at various clubs. Gyms are plenty and can be easily found.



Wankhede Stadium during the 2011 ICC World Cup Final

Learn

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

- **Cricket** - As cricket is like religion in India, many youngsters travel to Mumbai from different corners of India to get professional training in Cricket academies and educational institutes.
- **Film & TV production** - The craze of Bollywood attracts many people to try their luck in Mumbai. The city hosts many big film production houses and studios. Most of the big film producers and directors belong to this city and they have opened several training institutions to attract new talent.
- **Indian classical music** - The origins of Indian classical music are found in Vedas and the metropolitan city, Mumbai has been continuing the tradition. Most of the die-hard Indian classical music lovers operate training classes to pass on their talent to young generation.
- **Indian cooking** - Mumbai is real heaven for food lovers as one can get variety of food here. Food lovers not only love tasting variety of food but they also serve food to others by preserving their cooking talent. Many professional and amateur cook lovers offer free as well as paid classes to passionate learners.
- **Yoga** - Being highly busy city in India, the Mumbai people try to revive their life by taking part in different Yoga activities. In their rush schedule, Mumbaikars try to spend some time doing Yoga as they know role of these activities in their life.

Work

Nariman Point and Fort are the usual commercial hubs of the city and the most sought-after destinations. There is a significant expatriate population working in the banks and financial services industries. Bandra Kurla Complex (BKC) is a newer business district in Bandra.

The advertising industry is a prominent industry in Mumbai. Many of the top advertising companies such as Lintas, O&M, Saatchi & Saatchi, Contract, and Trikaya Grey have their offices in the city.

A good idea to make quick money is to work part-time in a BPO or a call centre most of which are concentrated at Mindspace, Malad (W) and Hiranandani Gardens (Powai). Only suitable for English speakers.

Foreigners can also earn a quick buck as extras in Bollywood films. Bring a book as there is a lot of time spent sitting around, so it's not something to do for the money. Normally you won't have to look for them as they will be asking tourists near Leopold's or your hotel manager may ask you when you book in.

Buy

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Visa, MasterCards and Indian RuPay cards are widely accepted in the city shops. Many shopping establishments also accept American Express, Diners and host of other cards. However, some of the small shops or family-run shops may not accept these cards and some handy cash can be of

help here. ATMs are widely available and many debit cards accepted as well. If you have an Indian bank account or credit card, you may not need to carry too much of cash. If you are a foreigner, it is a good idea to carry some cash to avoid charges while using your credit or debit card.

Many stores and websites accept payments using mobile wallets and Unified Payment Interface (UPI). Some of the popular payment apps are PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, BHIM and Amazon Pay.

In general, costs in Mumbai are higher than the rest of India, though they are still much lower by Western standards.

The shopping experience in the city is a study in contrasts. At the lower end of the spectrum are street vendors. Existing at the borderline of legality, entire streets have been given over to these hawkers and in many places it is impossible to walk on the footpaths, because they have blocked the way. On the other hand, these vendors often give you a great bargain though you will have to haggle a lot and be careful about what to buy. There's nothing like taking a local along to shop for you.

- **Family-run shops**, Or one could do shopping at family-run shops, where the items are behind the counter and one has to ask the salesperson to get items from the list. The traditional way to buy sarees or jewellery is to go to a shop where you sit on a bedspread laid out on the floor and the salespeople bring out their wares one-by-one until you make a decision. Shops like Bharat Kshetra in Dadar have scaled this model up to such an extent that they have a two-storied complex where you can do the same.
- **Shopping malls**, Mumbai has been experiencing a boom in malls in the past few years. You can combine your shopping, dining out, and watching movies all in one place.

What to buy

- **Antiques & second hand items**, Visit Chor Bazar for the best options and bargains
- **Burlingtons**, in the Taj is a tailor specializing in Indian outfits. Buy some material and get some clothes made up by a tailor. It's an incredibly cheap way to get quality made-to-measure clothes. Usually only takes a couple of days.
- **Carpets, rugs and shawls**
- **Cotton clothes**, Mumbai is great place to buy quality and cheaper cotton clothes. Amongst many notable shops and brands, Cottonworld is a place to look out for.
- **Dhoop**, (translates into Sunshine or Incense) A quaint, stylist store where you can find really interesting quality crafts and home accessories. On the corner of Union Park, Near Olive, Off Carter Road in Bandra.
- **Indian musical instruments**, Indian music has its own set of musical instruments such as Tabla, Harmonium, straight Flute that it relies upon. These can be brought at various music shops scattered across the city. Some well known shops are L.M.Furtado, Ghaisas & Bros.
- **Khadi clothing**, Khadi is an authentic Indian variety of home spun cotton. Mahatma Gandhi advocated the use of khadi as a form of satyagraha against the use of foreign goods and a form of rural self-employment for India during the pre-independence days. Check out the Khadi Gram Udyog Bhavan at 286, DN Road, Near the Mumbai GPO & Chatrapati Shivaji Terminus. It is run by the Khadi Gramudyog Vikas Samiti (<http://kgvs.org.in/>) which is an umbrella organization started by the Mahatma himself which today has evolved into a government registered unit promoting the use of khadi. A good place to buy souvenirs including khadi Indian flags. These are similar in type to the ones used during the freedom

struggle. It also houses other forms of fabrics like pure cotton wool, and silk. Some of the items make use of natural straw. Also offer a collection of handmade paper products.

- **Kurties and tunics'**, a must have in India. Linkin Laado has a wide range of classy kurties, fashion ethnic wear and exquisite dress materials in most sought after pure fabrics such as muls, cottons, maheshwari and chanderi silk in hand block prints and intrinsic chikankari work. The shop is at Link Square Mall, Shop No. F5, Opposite KFC, Above Croma, Linking Road, Bandra West.
- **Leather jackets**, go to the main road in Dharavi. You can fit yourself with a leather jacket (they stitch it for you) of leather you pick. Usually takes just one day to get it.
- **Luxury retail**, Mumbai has witnessed a massive boom in luxury retail. All the brands you can buy in any other major city are available there.
- **Pashmina**, cheap stuff is everywhere and decent shawls in every hue can be purchased at various markups in any hotel arcade. High-quality items in unusual colors and unique designs require more searching. The "pashminas" sold on Colaba Causeway are not anywhere close to pashmina.
- **Sarees**, the best place to buy them is Dadar (both east and west). The place is buzzing 12 months a year. On Sundays the crowd can be maddening for outsiders. Good shops to buy Sarees are Dadar Emporium, Lazaree, Roop Sangam. On N C Kelkar Road and Ranade Road you can buy almost everything a woman needs. Bargain hard.
- **Traditional clothing & handicrafts**, State government operated emporiums such as those for Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Jammu & Kashmir. sell state specific items of clothing and handicrafts. These are in places around South Mumbai or the shopping arcades of Five Star Hotels. There is also a Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India Emporium near the Gateway of India beside the Tendulkar's restaurant. The items on display include embroidered clothing, carvings, paintings, sculptures etc. and are reasonably priced. Amongst the private labels, Fabindia (<http://www.fabindia.com/index.asp>) is a must visit for its variety of kurtas [tunics], salwars, pyjamas, churidars & dupattas. They also offer bedspreads, cushion covers, decorative pillows, quilts, table linens, home furniture etc. Just like the government owned emporiums, Fabindia follows a cottage industry model that supports rural artisans and promotes traditional Indian crafts through contemporary clothing and home décor.. Good quality, smart colours, trendy designs but prices are a bit on the high side. Shops are found across Mumbai.

Bookshops

Mumbai has large numbers of organised bookshops. However it also has a number of streetside second hand book shops or displays that give opportunity to come across rare collections. Many of these roadside book shops can be prominently found, among many, near Flora Fountain, Maheshwari Udyyan (former King's Circle) and Dadar west market.

If you are somewhere in the Western Suburbs, Granth on Juhu Road could be a good bet to find the book you are looking for.

The Crossword chain of book shops has an outlet in most malls around the city, as well as the main store in Kemp's Corner.

Tourist traps

In a place without clearly displayed price tags (and sometimes even in places with), you will get charged about 3-4 times as much as a local if you seem like a tourist. Take a local with you if you're going to local markets to haggle. Haggling is much louder and ruder in India than elsewhere. Don't be afraid to haggle things down to 1/4 of the asking price. And most importantly

remember that almost all stores that sell carpets, jewelry, handicrafts, etc. pay huge amounts of commission (25% up to even 50%!) to the cab drivers, hence avoid tourist taxis, cabs, etc. Another thing to remember is not to haggle just for the fun of it. The shopkeepers may take offence if you don't buy an item after they have agreed to your price. One of the places that you can trust is The World Trade Centre (in Cuffe Parade, near Hotel Taj President). Besides being the only World Trade Centre in Mumbai, this place has an amazing range of exquisite carpets, handicrafts, shawls, etc. with reputed government approved stores and state emporiums too. Ask for receipts everywhere, including bars, and check what you have been charged for. Don't ever accept a guide offer or escort of somebody from the street: You will certainly get conned. If some place (including taxis, restaurants, shops, etc.) claims it doesn't have change (this is highly unlikely), insist they get change from a neighbouring shop.

Groceries

In addition to the local grocery stores which can be found on most of the streets, there are new additions to the city in the form of new big and small supermarkets and hypermarkets where you can get all the food items you need. Some of them are Reliance Retail (<https://relianceretail.com/>), Star Bazaar (<https://www.starquik.com/>), DMart, Spinach Local, Apna Bazaar.

Eat

The dining experience at an upscale restaurant in Mumbai is more or less the same as anywhere else in the world. You can find cuisine from the Middle East, Western Europe, North America and China easily. But to get a real flavour of what's unique to Mumbai, you will have to go a little lower down the scale and experience the street food and Irani cafes. Since March 2015, beef is banned in Maharashtra, and therefore in Mumbai. Therefore, it is uncommon to find beef served in restaurants. For individual restaurants and other places to eat, go to the individual district pages.



The Mumbai lunch consists of white rice, vegetable fries, dhal fries, onion, yoghurt and pooris. 

Don't leave Mumbai without trying:

- Alphonso Mangoes during summer season
- As many different kinds of chaat (Bhelpuri, Pav Bhaji etc.) as your stomach can handle
- Bread Maska (Bread & Butter) from an Irani Cafe
- Goan seafood
- Maharashtrian, Gujarati, Managlolean special, and Kerala Thali
- Indian Chinese
- Indian sweets: milky, delicious concoctions (try the kulfi falooda at Badshah's in Crawford market)
- Kebab rolls, Pattis, Keema
 - Particularly late-night at Bade Miyaan's behind the Taj near Colaba Causeway (also if the lights are off in order to avoid bribing the cops, do still try to approach it as it is likely to still be serving)

- Kingfisher Blue beer (not common in eateries, but only most "wine shops" (liquor stores)
- South Indian food from an Udipi restaurant
- Vada pav (the Indian veg burger): known to be the dish of Mumbai

Specialty restaurants

Popular search engines to find restaurants easily include Justdial (<http://www.justdial.com>), AskLaila (<http://www.asklaila.com/Mumbai/>) and DizzyLocal (<http://www.dizylocal.com/mumbai>). The search engines shall provide the address, contact details, and user ratings (if available) of the specific eatery (if name is provided), or list of eatery catering to the specialty (e.g. Seafood, Pubs, Chinese Food, etc.) depending on the location suggested (e.g. Worli, Bandra, South Mumbai etc.).

The suggested restaurant to have food at is Achija. It is spread across various branches that cover almost all parts of Mumbai. Achija's main dish is pav bhaji. Achija is always bustling. It also offers Jain pav bhaji making it a multi-religion meal. Apart from Pav Bhaji, it also provides dosa, idli, uttapam etc. Don't forget to try out the malai kulfi and falooda.

- **Seafood**, Apurva (Fort right off Horniman Circle). If you want to eat some authentic Indian (Konkan) seafood you must visit the Bharat Excellence. It is next to the Horniman Circle and the Reserve Bank of India. It is becoming pretty expensive. In the slightly higher price range, Trishna (at Kala Ghoda in Fort) and Mahesh Lunch Home (also in Fort) are very popular among both locals and tourists.
- **Chinese**, India Jones, (*Hilton Towers Mumbai*), Mainland China (Saki Naka), Ling's Pavilion (Colaba), Golden Dragon (Taj Mahal Hotel), Great Wall (Renaissance), Spices (JW Marriott), China Gate (Bandra), China White (Bandra). Bandra offers a range of Chinese Restaurants. Royal China at VT (behind Sterling Cinema serves some of the best DimSum the city has to offer). The new CG83 at Kemps corner is brilliant and the signature restaurant of Nelson Wang. Also new is Henry Thams. The food is brilliant as are the prices, however the bar is much more popular than the restaurant.
- **Combination Oriental**, India Jones (*Hilton Towers Mumbai*), Pan Asian (at Maratha Sheraton), Seijo, and Soul Dish (Bandra), Joss (Kala Ghoda) has some of the best East Asian food in the country and at moderate prices (compared to hotels). San Qi at the Four Seasons (Worli) combines East Asian and South Asian cuisine quite well.
- **Italian**, Shatranj Nepoli (*Bandra, Union Park*), Little Italy (Juhu next to Maneckji Cooper school), Don Giovanni's (Juhu, opposite JW Marriott), Mezzo Mezzo (at the JW Marriott), Vetro (at The Oberoi, Mumbai), Celini (at the Grand Hyatt), Mangi Ferra (Juhu), Taxi(Colaba), Spaghetti Kitchen (Phoenix Mills, Parel).
- **Japanese**, Wasabi by Morimoto (*Taj Mahal Hotel, Colaba*) is Mumbai's best and most expensive restaurant, but Japanese food is on the menus of most Pan Asian restaurants like Tiffin (The Oberoi, Mumbai), Pan Asian (Maratha Sheraton), India Jones (Hilton Towers Mumbai), and Spices (JW Marriott), Origami (Atria Mall Worli). Also Japengo Cafe at CR2 Mall in Nariman Point serves up some sushi. Tetsuma, adjacent to Prive (probably best nightclub in town) serves an average sushi but other dishes are worth a try. Best to go there for a cocktail and a few starters. 'Tian cafe' at Juhu is also a good place for sushi.
- **Lebanese Food**, Picadilly, at Colaba Causeway, the only restaurant in the city serving Lebanese food. Alcohol is not served.
- **Parsi**, Their ancestors originating from Iran, the Parsis are a special community of people that one would associate Mumbai with. Parsi food is based on ancient Persian cooking. Go to Britannia at Ballard Estate or Jimmy Boy close to Horniman Circle.

Street food stalls

Songs have been written about Mumbai's street food and you will find that the hype is justified. You will find them at every street corner, but they are concentrated in beaches and around railway stations.



Batata Vadas are a favorite of the Mumbai street food stalls

- **Bhelpuri stalls**, Selling what in the rest of India would be called *chaat*. In Mumbai itself, the term chaat is rarely used.
- **Bhurji**, Either Egg bhurji or Paneer bhurji, a mash of eggs and chopped tomato, onion, chili, and lots of oil. Eaten on the side with some pav. Try the Maker Chamber area (near Crossroads 2, Nariman Point).
- **Chinese food stalls**, You'll find them at many places, but they are particularly concentrated near Dadar railway station. They all have a typical Indian twist added to it, which is why it is frequently called "Indian Chinese". Although it is great tasting, the hygiene of these places leaves a lot to be desired.
- **Rolls**, Essentially different meat and cheese grilled and served with some Roti and spice, these are cheap and cheerful for anyone with a stomach that can handle it. They are known to be spicy so always ask them to make it mild. Try Ayubs (Kala Ghoda), Bade Miyan (behind Taj and near Colaba Causeway), Khao Gulli (Food Lane, near Mahim Hindu Gymkhana), or Kareems (Bandra). All are particularly busy after a night of heavy drinking.
- **Sandwich stands**, Uniquely developed in Mumbai, you won't find anything like it anywhere else in India or the world.
- **Vada pav stands**, Fried potato stuffed in yeasty bread. Developed to provide nourishment to mill-workers in Mumbai's burgeoning mills. Now they are found everywhere, particularly in the railway stations. This is a Mumbai specialty. In Vile Parle (West), try the one off S.V Road near Irla across from Goklibai School. One of the most popular ones are opposite Mithibai College which is about 15 mins walk from Vile Parle Station. Also try the one outside Grant Road Station and Churchgate Station.

Tip: cheap and tasty food stalls are concentrated around the city's colleges.

Street stall food in India is fantastic, and very cheap. However, do consider well what you are putting in your mouth. Almost certainly the water used is non-potable, street vendors don't seem to understand much about hygiene or hand-washing, and food safety standards are low, with flies buzzing over everything. Even locals steer clear of street food during the monsoons, when diseases run rampant. If the stall seems very clean, and if it clearly states that it is using Aquaguard or mineral water, go for it.

Authentic Marathi cuisine

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Mumbai, being home to a large ethnic Marathi community, has its share of notable restaurants that offer authentic Marathi cuisine. Most offer both snacks and regular dining. Some of the snacks to check out are Sabudana Wada, Batata Wada, Missal, Kanda Poha, Uppit (or Upma), Shira, Alu Wadi, Thalipith, Zunka Bhakari, ghavane (neer dosa) and many more. Two notable appetisers are Kokam Sarbat and Solkadhi which are best enjoyed during hot summers. People

say that many of these authentic Marathi restaurants are finding it difficult to survive competition with other modern or fast food-type restaurants, but you will find Gajali, Malvan Kinara, Sindhudurg and many more have retained their own charm and clientele.

Udupi restaurants

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Mangalorians (and Udupi) form the highest tourist populations of Mumbai, and both cities have similar culture and architecture. "Udupi" restaurants (or "hotels") are everywhere. They bear the name of the town of Udupi in Karnataka, but do not be misled into thinking that they specialise in the cuisine of Udupi. They serve pretty much everything, and that is their specialty.

Usually strictly vegetarian, these restaurants were opened by migrants from the district of Dakshina Kannada in Karnataka (of which Udupi is a part), to satisfy the palates of other migrants from the district. Over time, they gained popularity as places to have South Indian food. As the tastes of their customers evolved, so too did their menus, so much that now you can find Mughlai, Indian Chinese, Bhelpuri, and other chaats in addition to South Indian stuff. Amazingly, some places serve imitations of pizzas, burgers, and sandwiches too!

They are fast food joints and sit-down restaurants combined. The reason to visit them is not to experience fine gourmet dining, but to have cheap, passably tasty and fairly hygienic food. There is no easy way to identify an Udupi restaurant; they are not a chain of restaurants and they may not have "Udupi" in their name, so you will have to ask.

Matunga (Central line) has the best south Indian fare in Mumbai. There are few restaurants which could well be heritage sites as they are more than 50 years old and still retain their old world charm (and furniture).

Irani cafes

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Irani cafes are Persian styled cafes opened by 19th century Persian migrants from Iran. These cafes have a unique lazy atmosphere, display of day-to-day accessories including toothpastes behind the cashier, soaps and what nots (specially targeted at bachelor crowds) and furniture. Most of these cafes were at the corner of the road or building and were chosen spots by commuters to spend time. It was quite a usual sight to find people spending hours reading newspapers over a cup of tea for hours in these places. Sadly the new restaurants and fast food culture has almost removed these cafes from the maps, though few notables like **Kyani & Co.** and **Olympia** remain. The joints are best known for their "Irani Chai", "Bun-Maska/Maska Pav" (bread and butter) and Egg Omelette. Also are popular their assorted snacks, like Kheema-na-Patice, samosas, mava-na-cakes, etc. One of the best dish which is almost always on the menu is Kheema (prepared from ground meat) and pav (bread). Don't miss the Mawa Cake at Merwan & Co, a bustling Irani cafe next to Grant Road station and be there before 9AM when the delicious cakes tend to run out.

Thalis

If you order a thali (translated as "plate"), you get a complete meal arranged on your plate, with a roti or chappati, rice, and many different varieties of curries and curd. Ordering a thali is a popular option when you are hungry and in a hurry as it is usually served blazingly fast. Most mid-level restaurants have a thali on the menu, at least during lunch hours. Occasionally, they are "unlimited", which means that some of the items are all-you-can-eat. The waiters serve them at your table.

Of course, you find many varieties of them, both vegetarian and non-vegetarian. There is the South Indian thali. The "North Indian" thali translates to Mughlai or Punjabi. Do try Gujarati or Rajasthani thalis if you can find them. They are sinfully filling and tasty. Rajdhani (At Crawford Market) serves up thalis in the Rajasthani style while Aram (near Mahim Church, Mahim), Ramanayak Udipi (At Matunga Station, east) serves up thalis in South Indian style and Shree Thakker Bhojanalaya (off Kalbadevi Road) do filling and fabulous Gujarati thalis.

Fast food chains

Western fast food chains like McDonalds, Subway, Pizza Hut, Dominos, Kentucky Fried Chicken etc. have many outlets all over the city. But if you are a weary Westerner looking for the taste of the familiar, be warned that all of them have rather heavily Indianised their menus, so you will find the stuff there as exotic as you found Bambaiyya food. There are chains serving Indian food such as Jumbo King (<https://jumboking.co.in/>) whose menu includes vada and lassi. Barista (<http://www.barista.co.in>), Cafe Coffee Day (<http://www.cafecoffeeday.com>), and Smokin' Joe's (<http://www.smokinjoespizza.com/>) are all Indian chains, although they don't serve Indian food. While Barista and Cafe Coffee Day, as their names suggest, serve coffee and pastries, Smokin' Joe's serves decent pizzas and is headquartered in Carmichael Rd, Mumbai. International coffee chains like The Coffee Bean and Tea Leaf, Aromas have outlets in Mumbai.

Naturals is a chain of ice cream stores that serves up tasty and unconventional flavours of ice creams. Try their tender coconut or the coffee walnut ice creams. Its main branch is in Juhu in the Western suburbs (hence the tagline - 'Ice cream of Juhu Scheme'), but it has franchises at many places including Marine Drive, Bandra, Nepean sea road, etc. Naturals is also famous for its seasonal "Sitaphal" or Custard Apple Ice-cream. Baskin-Robbins is an international ice cream chain having its presence throughout the city. Also there are a number of shops in malls amongst other places which serve Italian Gelato ice cream.

Try the sumptuous creamy crepes and omelets at Crepe Station, Bandra. It's owned by a famous Bollywood actor, Dino Morea.

What to eat

Asking a local for suggestions is a fun way to try new things. Here are a few suggestions:

- **Bhel Puri & sev puri**, A classic Mumbai concoction, bhel-puri (or bhel for short) consists mostly of puffed rice and assorted spices with a few chutneys. You can specify whether you want it spicy or bland and the vendor will make it for you. It is quite tasty and again ought to be had off the streets to get the real flavour. Most people like to flock to Juhu Beach to try this out.
- **Hapus (Alphonso) mangoes**, A must try, if you happen to be in Mumbai in the summer.

- **Indian-Chinese**, Nothing like regular Chinese food. For a typical Bumbaiyya flavour, try the **Chinese Bhelpuri**!
- **Mewad ice cream**, If you happen to be in Mumbai, it is recommended you avoid ice creams from the famous and expensive parlors and try out the cheap Mewad ice cream stalls. They are a lovely treat at their price and provide a lot of options. The vendors are found everywhere across the streets, but avoid those who appear unhygienic.
- **Pani Puri**, The vendor hands you a plate. Next he takes a puri (it looks like a golf ball, but brown in colour), makes a small hole in it, and dips the puri into two jars. These jars contain water, one tangy on a tamarind base and the other spicy on a mint base. He tops it off with some condiments and places the puri on your plate. You pick it with your hand and pop the whole thing into your mouth. To avoid stomach problems only buy from vendors using packaged water.
- **Pav Bhaji**, Part of the street food culture, this is mashed vegetables cooked in spices, topped with butter and served piping hot with pav. Widely available.
- **Vada Pav**, the vada is a mashed potato patty. Pav is a kind of bread that has its roots in Mumbai. (The word comes from the Portuguese word "pão", for bread). The potato patty is sandwiched in the bread. Liberal helpings of three kinds of chutneys are added to the sandwich to make a tasty snack. It is widely available on the streets and generally costs around ₹6 a piece. If you feel uncomfortable with the hygiene of a particular stall, avoid it. In that case eating at Jumbo King Vada Pav (<http://www.jumboking.co.in/>) outlets, found almost at all train stations in the city, is a hygienic and safer option.
- **Variations of world cuisine** such as Tandoori Chicken Pizzas, the Bombay Masala Pizza or McAloo Tikki burgers.



Indian Cuisine



Tipping

Tipping is not expected, but would be appreciated. However, if a place includes service charges on the bill, you don't need to leave an extra tip. Note the difference between service tax and service charges. Service tax goes to Government and not to the staff.

Drink

Pubs and bars

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Mumbai is one of the most liberal cities in India when it comes to attitudes to alcohol. Bars exist at virtually every street corner and many of them advertise themselves as "family" bars and restaurants, which indicates that they are primarily restaurants where one can also have a drink. Other places are primarily bars, some of them might be sleazy. In South Mumbai and in the Western Suburbs, you are likely to find many places where foreigners hang out.

Mumbai is much more accepting of women drinking than the rest of India. A woman ordering a drink is unlikely to raise eyebrows even in mid-range bars, though if you are alone, you might need to look out for your safety.

Nightlife in Mumbai spans the gamut from performances at five star hotels to discos. Dance bars which involve young, fully clothed women dancing mostly to Hindi film and pop music, have been shut down by the government for "corrupting the morals" of those who frequent those places. While the state high court has ruled that the crackdown was illegal, it will be a while before they open again as there are some technicalities involved to be sorted out.

In Mumbai, alcohol is much more easily available than many cities in India.

LGBT options

There is already a lively late night, if somewhat subterranean, scene for gays, as well as social and political networks. However, you need to do your homework before arriving, as LGBT gathering spaces and organizations are not published or available at local newsstands. However, Bombay Dost (Bombay Friends) the only magazine catering to the community, after 7 years of running was closed and relaunched in 2009. Much of Mumbai's LGBT scene is coordinated using social networking sites and groups. Use extreme caution; robberies, hustlers, and even police entrapment are not unheard of.

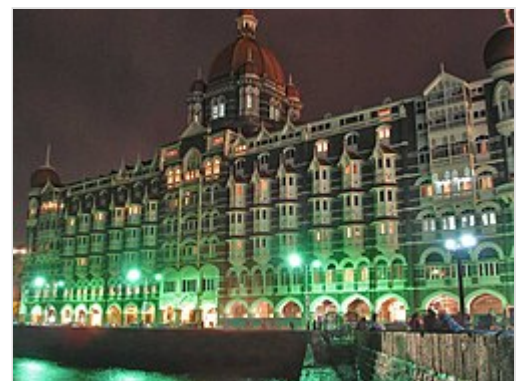
Coffee shops

There many coffee shops in and around Mumbai. Try the **Cafe Coffee Day** (<http://www.cafe-coffee.com/>) and **Barista** (<http://www.barista.co.in>) chains. Also, three Starbucks stores were opened in Mumbai in late 2012, and more are likely to follow. These are the best around town and also serve some pretty neat coffee for cheap. There's the **Cafe Mocha** chain of coffee shops which also serve fruit flavoured hookas — South Asian smoking pipes. If a small coffee and cookies place is what you are looking for, try **Theobroma**, it has an outlet at Cusrow Baug in Colaba. Those looking for a more native form of coffee can try the filter coffee, a milky coffee with origins from South India, from any Udupi restaurant.

Sleep

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

It is very difficult to find good-budget hotels in Mumbai. If you are a tourist or a business traveller, you may have to stay in South Mumbai, which is where both the business district and the touristy areas are. Lack of space means that even the cheapest hotel charges stratospheric tariffs. The state of public transport and traffic means that it is not really a good choice to stay anywhere else. In any case, things aren't much better if you are looking for hotels close to the airport. You should be looking at the Western Suburbs in that case. There are many guest houses at Colaba, where you find most of the budget foreign travellers stay. Other budget hotels are found near railway stations, such as Dadar or Santacruz, but most of them are absolute dumps. One safe and economical place to stay in Mumbai is the YMCA. Reasonably priced accommodations are available at the Colaba, Bombay Central, Andheri and CBD Belapur Branches.



Taj Mahal Hotel at night



One inexpensive alternative is to live with a local family as a paying guest. A list of available families can be obtained from the Government of India tourist office (+91 22 2220 7433) opposite Churchgate **Western**.

On the other hand, if money is of no object, you can stay at the Taj in Colaba (the oldest in India), the Leela Kempinski, the ITC Grand Maratha, or the JW Marriott Mumbai, Renaissance Mumbai Hotel & Convention Centre.

Connect

Individual listings can be found in Mumbai's district articles

Landlines

The area code for Mumbai is "22" (prefix "+91", if you are calling from outside India). Phone numbers are eight digits long, but on occasion you will find a seven digit number listed. That is probably an old listing. They made the changeover from seven to eight digits a few years back, when they allowed private service providers to offer telephone. Just prefix a "2" to the number and it should work just fine.

Pay phones

Phone booths can be found all over the city. Though they are coin operated, there is usually someone to run the place. (Typically the phones are attached to a roadside shop.) You need to keep putting ₹1 coins into the slot to extend the talk time, so keep a change of ₹1 coins handy with you. The person running the booth will usually have them. If you find a booth marked STD/ISD, you can call internationally or anywhere within the country. Fees will be charged according to the time spent and a meter runs to keep track of your time. You pay when you have finished your call. Often it is difficult to find one that is open early in the morning or late at night.

Mobile phones

Cell phone coverage in the city is excellent. There are many service providers offering a wide variety of plans. Among them are The MTNL (<http://www.mumbai.mtnl.net.in>), Vodafone Idea (Vi), Airtel (<http://www.airtelworld.com/>), Dolphin (<http://dolphin.mumbai.mtnl.net.in/>), Reliance Jio, and Tata Indicom (<http://www.tataindicom.com/>). It might be a good idea to buy a cell phone and use one of those prepaid plans to get yourself connected while you are in the city.

All mobile numbers are 10 digits long and begin with a "9", "8" or "7". Do not dial the city prefix for mobile numbers. If you don't get through to a mobile number, try adding a "0" before you dial it.

Due to security threats, in order to purchase a SIM card you will need to provide formal identification.

Cybercafes

Cybercafes are found on virtually every street corner and the rates are quite low. They have probably not kept pace with advances in hardware or software, also data security could be an issue. As a precaution, change your password after you use it at a cybercafe or do private/incognito browsing.

WiFi

Finding WiFi will be difficult in many parts of Mumbai, however, nearly all railway stations have been upgraded with 'RailWire' WiFi powered by Google that lets you browse for 45 mins at 5-10 Mbit/s speeds. RailWire WiFi requires you to authenticate with your mobile number and OTP. WiFi is also available at most hotels and restaurants. Airport WiFi is provided by Vodafone Idea.

Postal services

The Indian Postal service's head office is housed at GPO, a magnificent colonial architecture on its own; next to the C.S.T. railway station. The other main branch office can be found at Dadar (E) on Ambedkar Rd.

Stay safe

Unlike other parts of the country, especially Delhi where rape is prevalent, crime is rare, except for possibly common crime like pickpocketing.

Violent crime in Mumbai is more or less like any other large Indian city.

It is best to err on the side of safety and act according to your local environment. Here are a few basic safety tips:

- Keep your money and credit cards safe at all times. Always carry some cash as many places won't take cards.
- Do not openly display ₹500 and ₹2,000 notes in public. The available currency notes are ₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹500 and ₹2,000 and the available coins for tender are ₹1, ₹2, ₹5 and ₹10. Beware of someone giving you currency notes of any other denomination (though it is very unlikely; as they would have to be exchanged with the Reserve Bank of India; the central bank of India). The Indian government demonetised the old ₹500 and ₹1,000 currency notes in November 2016.
- Travelling in Mumbai is generally safe at any time of the day or night. The risks primarily run if you are not aware of the fares and fare calculations (only applicable to non-electronic and non-prepaid meters). If you travel alone, especially in night, then always see the meter by yourself and then pay the fare. If you are alone, sit in front so that you can see the meter.
- There have been cases where taxi drivers con people, mostly tourists, by taking longer routes, charging extra for luggage, tampering with the meter and fooling the passenger by exchanging ₹500 with a ₹100 note within fraction of seconds and making the passenger believe that he/she has handed over a ₹100 note. Thus, in order to avoid getting fooled, prefer app based taxi services like Ola and Uber for commuting.
- Beware of pickpockets on buses and trains. Do not put your wallet or other valuables in outside pockets of your bag, such that someone may be able to slip it out without your noticing.

- Also beware of mobile, chain, or bag snatchers who operate in densely populated places, such as railway stations, busy roads, and traffic signals.
- Women traveling by train, especially on off-peak routes should travel in the second class where at least a few co-passengers are also found.
- Women (especially Westerners) should avoid crowded places, you might well get groped. Cases of men pinching or touching women are common in crowded public places, including nicer nightspots. Create a scene if this does happen to you, there will be enough people around that will come to your defence. In general, in Mumbai, if you are ever worried about your safety, make a loud scene. It is an extremely crowded city, and somebody is always around and willing to help.
- Women should never ever take lifts from strangers. Western women tourists should note that if they visit a disco or pub in Mumbai or India, don't take lifts or even get too friendly with strangers. You will almost certainly get conned, if not worse. Many Indian men presume that if you're foreign you must be easy.
- Don't ever let an auto or taxi you are traveling in pick up any more people, or pull over before your final destination.
- Police can sometimes be almost as shady as criminals in Mumbai. At night, women should ensure if they are ever stopped by police, there needs to be a female police officer present or they are well within their rights in demanding the presence of a woman cop.
- Think twice about eating food that has not been thoroughly heated. This may be especially true if you're eating street food.

Emergency numbers

- **Mumbai Police** (<http://www.mumbaipolice.org>), ☎ 100 (Mumbai Police Control Room), 1090 (Police Infoline), +91 22 22026636 (D. G. Control).
- **Mumbai Police** (<http://www.mumbaipolice.org>), ☎ +91 22 22625020 (Mumbai Police Head Quarter), +91 22 28854643 (North Control), +91 22 25233588 (East Control), +91 22 26457900 (West Control), +91 22 23089855 (South Div.), +91 22 23750909 (Central Div).
- **Traffic Police** (<http://www.trafficpolicemumbai.org>), ☎ +91 22 24937746 (Traffic Control), +91 22 30403040 (Traffic Helpline).

Railways

- **Churchgate**, ☎ +91 22 22017420.
- **C.S.T.**, ☎ +91 22 22622685.
- **Central Rly. C.S.T.**, ☎ +91 22 22620173.
- **Western Rly. Central**, ☎ +91 22 23070197.

Airport

- **Santacruz Airport**, ☎ +91 22 26156600.
- **Sahar Terminal (NIPTC)**, ☎ +91 22 26829000.
- **Air India Enquiry**, ☎ +91 22 22796666.

Air Ambulance

- **Domestic/International** (<http://www.vibha.info/>), ☎ +91 9821150889.

- **Fire Station**, ☎ 101, [+91 22 23076111](tel:+912223076111), [+91 22 23086181](tel:+912223086181), [+91 22 2306112](tel:+91222306112), [+91 22 2306113](tel:+91222306113).
- **Coast Guard**, ☎ [+91 22 24376133](tel:+912224376133), [+91 22 24371932](tel:+912224371932).

Stay healthy

As elsewhere in India, be careful with what you eat. Outside of major tourist hotels and restaurants, stay away from raw leafy vegetables, egg-based dressings like mayonnaise and minced meat are particularly risky. In short, stick to boiled, baked, fried or peeled goods.

Opinions on tap water vary, but most visitors choose to stick to the bottled stuff. Large bottles of water can be purchased at a very low cost. When buying water from street vendors, make sure the lid is sealed: there have been cases of bottles being filled with tap water and sold as new.

Smog can reach unhealthful levels, especially during the dry season. This, coupled with the summer heat and humidity can make spending time outdoors quite unpleasant.

Numerous fitness centres exist throughout the city. Many exercise facilities and spas offer 24-hour memberships for visitors and are a popular way to unwind after a long day of touring in Mumbai.

Cope

Maps

- **City Map**, Eicher has an excellent city-map of Mumbai with detailed listings. Familiarise yourself with it before you begin, or alternatively trace your route on it.
- **BEST Route Map**, Thanks to the density of bus routes in the city, the map is quite hard to decipher. Although bus routes are listed in the itinerary, you may have to find out about a few others if you plan to mix/match the order of the sights. People are very helpful in general. Check the BEST Route Finder for detailed information on the routes. You can also download the Chalo (https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=app.zophop&hl=en_IN) app on Android. It can also track buses but it is somewhat unreliable.

Newspapers

Local newspapers can be handy and reliable sources for day to day updates about the city. The city has number of newspapers and other publication that list local happenings. *The Times of India* (<http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/>) has a supplement called *Bombay Times*. There are also other papers like *The Asian Age* (<http://www.asianage.com>), *DNA* (<http://www.dnaindia.com>), *Indian Express* (<http://indianexpress.com/>), *Hindustan Times* (<http://www.hindustantimes.com>) and *Free Press Journal* (<http://www.freepressjournal.in>). For the business updates, check *Economic Times* (<http://economictimes.indiatimes.com>).

There are three very good local city tabloids called *Mid-Day* (<http://www.mid-day.com>), *Mumbai Mirror* (<http://www.mumbaimirror.com>), and *Afternoon*. These papers are city focused and cover a lot of gossip, local news, and have plenty of entertainment listings. One could refer to these papers for any specific activity. In addition, *Time Out* now has an excellent

Mumbai edition each month which can be picked up on street bookshops. It is a little more eclectic than the others listed here. All of these papers have information on arts, dance, eating out, food festivals, events, exhibitions, lectures, movies, theatre listings, concerts, seminars, and workshops.

There are also many local newspapers in regional languages such as *Lok Satta* (<http://www.loksatta.com>) (Marathi), *Maharashtra Times* (<http://maharashtratimes.indiatimes.com>) (Marathi), *Saamna* (<http://www.saamna.com>) (Marathi), *Navakal* (<http://www.navakal.com>) (Marathi), *Janmabhoomi* (Gujarati), *Mumbai Samachar* (<http://www.bombaysamachar.com>) (Gujarati) and *Navbharat Times* (<http://navbharattimes.indiatimes.com>) (Hindi) which cater to local and regional interests and tastes.

Radio

There are 12 radio stations in Mumbai, with nine broadcasting on the FM band, and three All India Radio stations broadcasting on the AM band. Mumbai also has access to commercial radio providers such as SiriusXM.

Hospitals

- **Bai Sakarbai Dinshaw Petit Hospital for Animals** (Bail Ghoda (Bull Horse) Hospital), Parel, ☎ +91 22 24135285, +91 22 24135434, +91 22 24137518. The Bombay Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (SPCA) is also headquartered here. Their ambulance rushes in answer to any call of distress to animals. (updated Jun 2023 |)
- **1 Bombay Hospital** (<http://bombayhospital.com>). (updated Mar 2026 |)
- **2 Cama Hospital**. (updated Jun 2023 |)
- **3 Gokuldas Tejpal Hospital**. (updated Jun 2023 |)
- **4 King Edward Memorial Hospital** (<http://www.kem.edu/>). (updated Jun 2023 |)
- **5 Sir Jamshedjee Jeejeebhoy Hospital** (<http://www.gmcjjh.org>) (Sir J. J. Hospital). (updated Mar 2026 |)
- **6 St. George Hospital** (<http://www.stgeorghospital.in/>). (updated Jun 2023 |)
- **7 Tata Memorial Cancer Research Hospital**. (updated Mar 2026 |)

Diagnostic centres

- **Soningra Polyclinic**, B - Helal Bldg, Dr. Mascarenhas Rd, Mazgaon, ☎ +91 22 23715963, +91 22 2749662. Since 1984, catering the nation since last 25 years effectively and efficiently.
- **Wellspring** (<http://www.wellspring.in/>), Ganpatrao Kadam Marg, Near A to Z Industrial Estate, Off Worli Naka, Lower Parel(W). Another premier diagnostic laboratory owned by the Piramal group. Along with the above they have other centers as well throughout the city.

24 hour chemists

- **Parel Chemist**, Opp. Wadia Maternity Hospital, Parel, ☎ +91 22 4131299, +91 22 24129751.
- **Mumbai Medico**, Bhatia Hospital, Tardeo, ☎ +91 22 23086641.

Consulates

-  **8 Australia** (<http://mumbai.consulate.gov.au/mbai/home.html>), Level 10, A Wing, Parinee Crescenzo, Plot C 38-39, G Block, BKC, ☎ [+91 22 6669 2000](tel:+912266692000), [+91 22 6757 4900](tel:+912267574900). M-F 8:30AM–4:45PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **9 Argentina** (<http://cgmum.cancilleria.gov.ar>), 10F, Chander Mukhi Bldg, Unit A, Nariman Point, ☎ [+91 22 2287 1381](tel:+912222871381). M-F 9AM-5PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **Afghanistan**, 115 Next To Governor's Gate, Walkeshwar Rd, Malabar Hill, ☎ [+91 22 2363 3777](tel:+912223633777).
-  **10 Belgium** (<http://diplomatie.belgium.be/india/>), TCG Financial Centre, 7th floor, C-53, G-Block, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra(E) (*From Kurla station 2.5 km (1.6 mi) West*).
-  **11 Brazil** (<http://mumbai.itamaraty.gov.br/en-us/>), Units 113 & 114, Free Press House, 11F, Free Press Journal Marg, Nariman Point, ☎ [+91 22 2283 4467](tel:+912222834467), [+91 22 2283 4469](tel:+912222834469), [+91 9820686143](tel:+919820686143) (Mobile). (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **12 Canada** (<https://www.international.gc.ca/country-pays/india-inde/mumbai.aspx?lang=eng>), 21F, Indiabulls Financial Centre Tower 2, Elphinstone Rd, Parel West, ☎ [+91 22 6749 4444](tel:+912267494444), fax: [+91 22 6749 4454](tel:+912267494454). (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **13 China** (<http://mumbai.china-consulate.org/eng/>), 9F, Hoechst House, 193 Backbay Reclamation, Nariman Point, ☎ [+91 22 5632 4303-4-5](tel:+912256324303), fax: [+91 22 56324302](tel:+912256324302), chinaconsul_mum_in@mfa.gov.cn (mailto:chinaconsul_mum_in@mfa.gov.cn).
-  **Czech Republic**, 5 G, Marcopia, Dr G Deshmukh Marg, Cumballa Hill, Pedder Rd, Cumballa Hill, ☎ [+91 22 2351 8456](tel:+912223518456).
-  **Djibouti**, 15, World Trade Centre, Cuffe Parade, ☎ [+91 22 2285 3750-52](tel:+912222853750).
-  **Egypt**, Bhagwanlal Indrajit Rd, Teen Batti, Malabar Hill,.
-  **14 France** (<https://in.ambafrance.org/-Consulat-de-Bombay->), 5F, Wockhardt Towers, BKC, ☎ [+91 22 6669 4000](tel:+912266694000), fax: [+91 22 6669 4066](tel:+912266694066). M-Th 9AM-5PM, F 9AM-4:30PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **15 Germany Visa and Consular Department** (<http://www.mumbai.diplo.de/>), Arcadia Bldg, Ground Floor, Nariman Point, ☎ [+91 22 2280 7385](tel:+912222807385), fax: [+91 22 2284 2184](tel:+912222842184).
-  **16 Germany Consulate General** (http://www.india.diplo.de/Vertretung/indien/en/05_Mumbai/Mumbai.html) (Bundesrepublik Deutschland - Generalkonsulat), Hoechst House, 10th Floor, 193 Backbay Reclamation (Vinay K Shah Marg), Nariman Point, ☎ [+91 22 2283 2422](tel:+912222832422), fax: [+91 22 2202 5493](tel:+912222025493). M-F 9AM-midnight.
-  **Greece**, Baharestan, 30/A, Juhu Tara Rd, Juhu, ☎ [+91 22 660 7852](tel:+91226607852), fax: [+91 22 6606446](tel:+91226606446), jertony@yahoo.com (<mailto:jertony@yahoo.com>).
-  **Indonesia** (<https://www.kemlu.go.id/mumbai/en/default.aspx>), 19 Altamount Rd, Cumballa Hill, ☎ [+91 22 2351 1678](tel:+912223511678), [+91 22 2353 0940](tel:+912223530940), [+91 22 2353 0900](tel:+912223530900), kjrimumb@bom3.vsnl.net.in (<mailto:kjrimumb@bom3.vsnl.net.in>).
-  **Italy** (<http://www.consmumbai.esteri.it>), Kanchanjunga 1F, 72 G.Deshmukh Marg, ☎ [+91 22 23804071](tel:+912223804071), fax: [+91 22 2387 4074](tel:+912223874074).
-  **Iran** (<https://www.iranianvisa.com/iranian-consulate-in-mumbai-india/>), 47, 1st Floor, Swapna Lok, Nepeansea Rd, ☎ [+91 22 6688 7070](tel:+912266887070).
-  **Israel** (<http://embassies.gov.il/mumbai>), Marathon Futurex 1301, A Wing N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, NM Joshi Marg, BDD Chawl, Lower Parel, ☎ [+91 22 6160 0507](tel:+912261600507).
-  **17 Japan** (<https://www.mumbai.in.emb-japan.go.jp>), 1 ML Dahanukar Marg, Cumballa Hill, ☎ [+91 22 2351 7101](tel:+912223517101), fax: [+91 22 2351 7120](tel:+912223517120). M-F 9AM–1PM, 2–5:30PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **Kuwait**, Vaswani Mansions, Flat No. 1 & 2, 120, Dinsha Vachha Rd, ☎ [+91 22-2287 1897](tel:+912222871897).

-  **Malaysia** (<http://www.kln.gov.my/perwakilan/mumbai>), 4-B, 4F, Notan Plaza, Turner Rd, Bandra(W), ☎ +91 22 2645 5751, +91 22 2645 5752.
-  **18 Mexico** (<https://consulmex.sre.gob.mx/mumbai/index.php/en/>), GF, Arcadia Bldg, Nariman Point. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **Saudi Arabia**, Maker Tower “F”, 4F, Cuffe Parade, Colaba, ☎ +91 22 22156001, +91 22 2215 6002, +91 22 2215 6003, fax: +91 22 2215 6006.
-  **19 Singapore** (<http://www.mfa.gov.sg/mumbai/>), 152, 14F, Maker Chambers IV 222, Jamnalal Bajaj Rd, Nariman Point, ☎ +91 22 2204 3205, +91 22 2204 3209, fax: +91 22 2285 5812 (For visa matters only), +91 22 2204 3203 (For non-visa matters). M-F 9AM-5PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **20 South Korea** (<http://ind-mumbai.mofa.go.kr/english/as/ind-mumbai/main/index.jsp>), 12F, Lodha Supremus, Dr Elijah Moses Rd, Worli, ☎ +91 22 6147 7000. M-F 9AM-5PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **21 Switzerland** (<https://www.eda.admin.ch/countries/india/en/home/representations/consulate-general.html>), Maker Chambers IV, 222, Jamnalal Bajaj Rd, Nariman Point, ☎ +91 22 2283 1738. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **Thailand**, General, 1F, Dalamal House Jamnalal Bajaj Marg, Nariman Point, ☎ +91 22 2281 0808, fax: +91 22 22810808.
-  **22 Turkey** (<https://mumbai-bk.mfa.gov.tr>), Maker Chambers V, 51, Jamnalal Bajaj Marg, Nariman Point, ☎ +91 22 2204 0365, +91 22 2204 0366, consulate.mumbai@mfa.gov.tr (mailto:consulate.mumbai@mfa.gov.tr). M-F 9AM-1PM, 2PM-5PM. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **23 United Arab Emirates** (<https://www.mofaic.gov.ae/en/missions/uae-missions-abroad/uae-missions-abroad-details?countryId=b3e3dad0-b35f-4872-8981-d8fdd0ec6e6d>), Taj Wellington Mews, Cusrow Baug, ☎ +91 22 6634 5566, fax: +91 22 2218 0986, mumbaicon@mofaic.gov.ae (mailto:mumbaicon@mofaic.gov.ae). M-Th 9AM-4PM, F 9AM-noon. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **24 United Kingdom** (<https://www.gov.uk/world/organisations/british-deputy-high-commission-mumbai>), Naman Chambers, C/32, G Block, BKC, ☎ +91 22 6650 2222, +91 98200 00343 (Emergency Duty Officer), fax: +91 22 6650 2324. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **25 United States** (<https://in.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/mumbai/>), Lincoln House, 78 Bhulabhai Desai Rd (from Kurla station 2.2 km (1.4 mi) West), ☎ +91 22 2363 3611, fax: +91 22 2363 0350, MumbaiACS@state.gov (mailto:MumbaiACS@state.gov). Established in 1838. The consulate formerly functioned from Wankaner House, later renamed Lincoln House, at Breach Candy in South Mumbai since 1950. (The consular residence was Washington House on Altamount Road). The building, declared as a heritage site, is an erstwhile palace of Maharaja Vakaner. The palace was handed over to the U.S. consulate by the Maharaja to raise funds to pay off his taxes, after India became independent. In 2002, the consulate shifted its office to Bandra Kurla Complex (BKC) owing to security reasons. (updated Mar 2026 |)
-  **Vietnam** (<https://india-consulate.org.vn/>), B-603, Oberoi Chambers, New Link Rd, Andheri(W), ☎ +91 22 2673 6688, fax: +91 22 2673 6633.

Go next

- Ambernath (55 km (34 mi) NE - take a train to here) — See the Lord Shiva Temple (16th century)
- Chiplun (290 km (180 mi) S, on Konkan railway route between Khed & Ratnagiri Stns) — Here are the Chiveli Vagheshwari Temple and the Pandavas Caves
- Ratnagiri (300 km (190 mi) S, 6-7 hr journey in train from Mumbai, same comfortable using a (A/c & Non A/c) bus) — Ratnadurga Sea Fort, Thebaw Pagoda Palace

- Rajapur (350 km (220 mi) S, 8.5 hr) — Visit the Yeshwantgad, an island fortification
- Badlapur (50 km (31 mi) NE - to get in is by Local Trains (EMU), hourly) — Fort, Water Park
- Dombivli (30 km (19 mi) NE; 40 min in a fast train from CST to reach 'Kopar Stn.', by bus ~1 hr 30 min)
- Kalyan (60 km (37 mi) NE; by train towards Karjat or Kasara would reach Kalyan in around 45-55 min) - Visit the Fort
- Navi Mumbai — see the Belapur Fort ruins and watch cricket at DY Patil Stadium
- Thane (N 40 km (25 mi)) — also called *Lake City* due to the 30 lakes in and around the city
- **Raigad** — district of Maharashtra lies just south of Mumbai. It is famous for its beaches and forts. You can get there by road or by ferry from Mumbai. The important ferry routes are:
 - Ferry Wharf, Mazagaon, Mora (Uran).
 - Ferry Wharf, Mazagaon, Rewas (near Mandwa). These are in budget range.
 - Gateway of India, Rewas. Fast boats and Catamarans operated by private operators. Service approximately every two hours, suspended during the monsoon season, i.e. May-Oct. From Rewas, take a bus or car to Alibag.
- **Hill Stations** — following are some of the hill stations that can be weekend gateways from Mumbai:
 - Matheran (102 km (63 mi), 1.5 hr) — can be reached both by road and by train. For train option, take a suburban train to Neral and take hour long toy train to reach Matheran top. Alternatively it can be climbed
 - Lonavala (111.5 km (69.3 mi), 1.5 hr) — best reached by road. Suburban trains do not ply to Lonavala, and may need to exchange train at Karjat or take en route long-distance train
 - Khandala (101 km (63 mi), 1.5 hr) — check Lonavala
 - Dapoli (200 km (120 mi) S - by bus) -is a popular hill station also beaches, historical temples, caves and forts scattered around
 - Mahabaleshwar (242 km (150 mi), 7 hr) — best reached by road
- Lots of nearby destinations can be reached by short flights: Goa, Ahmedabad, Karachi and Rajkot, to name a few.



